# Phase 12: Faith, Hope & Forever

*The last nine books, then a celebration: we review all 66 books, hold the Bible Bowl, and finish the year with Graduation Sunday. Jesus wins, and God's story goes on forever!*

| At a Glance | |
|---|---|
| **Month** | Month 12 |
| **Books covered** | Hebrews, James, 1 Peter, 2 Peter, 1 John, 2 John, 3 John, Jude, Revelation (9 books) |
| **Bible section(s)** | General Letters (8) and Prophecy–Revelation (1) |
| **Big Idea** | Jesus is better than everything. Real faith shows in how we live, and one day Jesus will make everything new. |
| **Memory Verse (all ages)** | "Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever." — Hebrews 13:8 (NIV) |
| **Little Lambs verse** | "Jesus Christ is the same… forever." — Hebrews 13:8 |
| **Year verse (optional, for the whole-Bible review)** | "All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness." — 2 Timothy 3:16 (NIV) |
| **Theme color** | Crown Gold (with a sky-blue accent for the "new heaven and new earth") |
| **Phase symbol / badge** | 👑 The Forever Crown badge, plus the year-end **Whole Bible Champion** medal |
| **Running total of books learned** | **66 of 66. The whole Bible!** |

> Cross-links: Program Overview · Teacher Training Guide · Books of the Bible Memory System · Game Library · YouTube Video Guide · Phase 12 Printables

> **Planning note:** This month has more in it than usual. Weeks 1–4 teach the last nine books. The **Whole-Bible Review Plan** runs alongside them, in the 10-minute Welcome & Book Chant slot every week. The **Bible Bowl** and **Graduation Sunday** happen on Week 5, or on a special Sunday you choose. Everything for the review, the Bowl and Graduation is in the section **End-of-Phase Review & Celebration**.

## The Big Idea (in kid words)

We made it to the end of the Bible! The last letters were written by Jesus' friends and family: Peter, John, James, Jude, and the writer of Hebrews. They say: **Jesus is the best**, so keep trusting Him. **Real faith shows** in how we act and talk. **God is love**, so love one another. Then the very last book,

Revelation, shows us the ending of God's big story. **Jesus wins!** He will wipe away every tear and make everything new, and His people will live with Him forever.

**How this points to Jesus:** Hebrews says Jesus is better than angels, better than Moses, and better than every priest and sacrifice (Hebrews 1–10). Revelation shows Jesus as the Lamb who was slain and the Lion who has won (Revelation 5:5–6). The Bible starts in a garden with the tree of life (Genesis 2), and it ends in a garden-city with the tree of life (Revelation 22). Jesus brings us back home. He is "the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End" (Revelation 22:13).

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## The Books in Easy Words

> **Big tip for remembering:** The **General Letters** are mostly named after **who wrote them** (James, Peter, John, Jude). Paul's letters were named after **who received them**. The one exception is **Hebrews**, which is named after its readers (Hebrew/Jewish Christians). Count them on your fingers: **1** Hebrews, **2** James, **3–4** Peter, **5–7** John, **8** Jude. Then comes **Revelation**, the grand finale!

### 58. Hebrews

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | HEE-brooz |
| **How to spell it** | He-brews — H-E-B-R-E-W-S |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | Unknown! The letter doesn't say. People have guessed Paul, Barnabas, Apollos, and others. God knows, and that's enough. Probably written before AD 70. |
| **Kid summary** | Jesus is better than everything and everyone, so don't give up. Keep trusting Him like the heroes of faith did. |
| **In one word** | **Better** |
| **Key people** | Jesus (our great High Priest), Melchizedek, Moses, and the "Faith Hall of Fame" (ch. 11): Abel, Enoch, Noah, Abraham, Sarah, Isaac, Jacob, Joseph, Moses, Rahab, Gideon, Samson, David, Samuel, and more |
| **Key passages** | Jesus is "the radiance of God's glory" (1:3); "the word of God is alive and active" (4:12); we can "approach God's throne of grace with confidence" (4:16); "faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see" (11:1); "without faith it is impossible to please God" (11:6); "let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us, fixing our eyes on Jesus" (12:1–2); "Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever" (13:8) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | Everywhere! Jesus is the Son over God's house, the perfect High Priest, and the once-for-all sacrifice (7:27; 10:10–14). |

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|---|---|
| **Hand motion** | 🏆 Thumbs up, then move it higher, and higher again: "Good, better, BEST — Jesus!" |

## 59. James

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|---|---|
| **How to say it** | JAYMZ |
| **How to spell it** | James — J-A-M-E-S |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | James, the brother of Jesus. He didn't believe in Jesus at first (John 7:5). Then he met the risen Jesus (1 Corinthians 15:7) and became a leader of the Jerusalem church (Acts 15; Galatians 1:19). Probably one of the earliest New Testament books (about AD 45–49). |
| **Kid summary** | If you really trust Jesus, it will show in what you do and how you talk. |
| **In one word** | **Do** (faith that works!) |
| **Key people** | James. He also mentions Abraham, Rahab, Job and Elijah as examples. |
| **Key passages** | "If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God" (1:5); "Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry" (1:19); "Do not merely listen to the word... Do what it says" (1:22); "faith by itself, if it is not accompanied by action, is dead" (2:17); the tongue is like a small rudder that steers a big ship, or a small spark that sets a forest on fire (3:3–6); "Come near to God and he will come near to you" (4:8) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | James calls himself "a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ" (1:1). He echoes Jesus' Sermon on the Mount many times, and he waits for "the Lord's coming" (5:7–8). |
| **Hand motion** | 🛠️ Zip your lips (careful words), then roll up your sleeves (faith that works). |

## 60. 1 Peter

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | FIRST PEE-ter |
| **How to spell it** | Pe-ter — P-E-T-E-R |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | The apostle Peter, written with help from Silas (5:12). Probably from Rome, which he calls "Babylon" (5:13), about AD 62–64. |
| **Kid summary** | When life is hard because you follow Jesus, keep your hope in Him. He cares for you. |
| **In one word** | **Hope** |
| **Key people** | Peter, Silas, Mark (5:13) |

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|---|---|
| **Key passages** | God gave us "new birth into a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ" (1:3); "you also, like living stones, are being built into a spiritual house" (2:5); "Always be prepared to give an answer... for the hope that you have" (3:15); "Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you" (5:7); the devil prowls "like a roaring lion" (5:8) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | "He himself bore our sins in his body on the cross... by his wounds you have been healed" (2:24, quoting Isaiah 53). |
| **Hand motion** | 🪨 Hold up 1 finger, make a fist ("rock," since Peter's name means rock), then toss your worries up to God with both hands. |

## 61. 2 Peter

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | SEK-und PEE-ter |
| **How to spell it** | Pe-ter — P-E-T-E-R |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | The apostle Peter, near the end of his life (1:14), about AD 64–68 |
| **Kid summary** | Keep growing in Jesus, don't believe false teachers, and remember that God always keeps His promises. He is patient because He wants everyone to come to Him. |
| **In one word** | **Grow** |
| **Key people** | Peter. He mentions Paul ("our dear brother," 3:15), Noah and Lot. |
| **Key passages** | Peter was an eyewitness of Jesus' glory on the mountain (1:16–18); "With the Lord a day is like a thousand years" (3:8); "He is patient with you, not wanting anyone to perish, but everyone to come to repentance" (3:9); "grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ" (3:18) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | Peter heard God say, "This is my Son, whom I love" (1:17). Jesus is coming back as He promised (3:10–13). |
| **Hand motion** | 🌱 Hold up 2 fingers, then crouch and "grow" up tall like a plant. |

## 62. 1 John

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | FIRST JAHN |
| **How to spell it** | John — J-O-H-N (silent **H**!) |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | The apostle John, "the disciple whom Jesus loved." He wrote it as an older man, about AD 85–95. |
| **Kid summary** | God is love. When we trust Jesus, God forgives us, we become His children, and we love one another. |
| **In one word** | **Love** |
| **Key people** | John, who calls his readers "dear children" |

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|---|---|
| **Key passages** | "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins" (1:9); "See what great love the Father has lavished on us, that we should be called children of God!" (3:1); "God is love" (4:8); "We love because he first loved us" (4:19); "I write these things to you... so that you may know that you have eternal life" (5:13) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | John touched and saw Jesus, "the Word of life" (1:1). Jesus is "the atoning sacrifice for our sins" (2:2). |
| **Hand motion** | 🤗 Hold up 1 finger, then give yourself a big hug: "God is love!" |

## 63. 2 John

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | SEK-und JAHN |
| **How to spell it** | John — J-O-H-N |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | John, who calls himself "the elder." It has 13 verses, the fewest verses of any book in the Bible. |
| **Kid summary** | A short note to a church family (called "the lady chosen by God and her children"): keep walking in truth and love, and watch out for false teachers. |
| **In one word** | **Truth** |
| **Key people** | John, "the lady chosen by God," and her children |
| **Key passages** | "This is love: that we walk in obedience to his commands" (v. 6) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | John warns about people who deny that "Jesus Christ [came] in the flesh" (v. 7). Jesus really became human. |
| **Hand motion** | 🚶 Hold up 2 fingers, then march in place: "Walk in truth!" |

## 64. 3 John

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | THURD JAHN |
| **How to spell it** | John — J-O-H-N |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | John, "the elder." In the original Greek it is the shortest book in the Bible by word count. |
| **Kid summary** | John thanks his friend Gaius for welcoming and helping Christian travelers, warns about a bossy man named Diotrephes, and praises a good man named Demetrius. |
| **In one word** | **Welcome** |
| **Key people** | Gaius (good host), Diotrephes (wanted to be first), Demetrius (good example) |
| **Key passages** | "I have no greater joy than to hear that my children are walking in the truth" (v. 4); "Do not imitate what is evil but what is good" (v. 11) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | The travelers went out "for the sake of the Name," meaning Jesus' name (v. 7). |
| **Hand motion** | 👋 Hold up 3 fingers, then wave a big "Welcome!" |

## 65. Jude

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | JOOD |
| **How to spell it** | Jude — J-U-D-E |
| **Section** | General Letters |
| **Author** | Jude, "a brother of James" (v. 1), which makes him another brother of Jesus. About AD 65–80. Only 25 verses. |
| **Kid summary** | Stand strong for the true message about Jesus, and remember that God is able to keep you from falling. |
| **In one word** | **Stand** (or **Keep**) |
| **Key people** | Jude. He mentions Michael the archangel, Enoch, Cain, Balaam and Korah as examples. |
| **Key passages** | "Contend for the faith that was once for all entrusted to God's holy people" (v. 3); "To him who is able to keep you from stumbling and to present you before his glorious presence without fault and with great joy" (v. 24) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | "Our only Sovereign and Lord, Jesus Christ" (v. 4). Jesus keeps us (v. 1) and brings us to eternal life (v. 21). |
| **Hand motion** | 🛡️ Pretend to trip, then catch yourself with both arms out: "God keeps me from falling!" |

## 66. Revelation

| | |
|---|---|
| **How to say it** | rev-uh-LAY-shun (it's **Revelation**, with no "s" on the end!) |
| **How to spell it** | Rev-e-la-tion — R-E-V-E-L-A-T-I-O-N |
| **Section** | Prophecy–Revelation (the only book in this section) |
| **Author** | The apostle John, while he was exiled on the island of Patmos (1:9), about AD 95 |
| **Kid summary** | Jesus shows John amazing visions: Jesus is alive and in charge, evil will be defeated, and God will make a new heaven and a new earth where His people live with Him forever. |
| **In one word** | **Wins!** (or **New**) |
| **Key people** | Jesus (the Lamb, the Lion of the tribe of Judah, the King of kings), John, angels, the seven churches |
| **Key passages** | Jesus: "I am the First and the Last. I am the Living One; I was dead, and now look, I am alive for ever and ever!" (1:17–18); letters to seven churches: Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, Laodicea (ch. 2–3); "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock" (3:20); the throne room and the Lamb (ch. 4–5); "He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain" (21:4); "I am making everything new!" (21:5); the river of life and the tree of life (22:1–2); "Come, Lord Jesus" (22:20) |
| **Where Jesus shows up** | Jesus is the main character of Revelation. The first verse calls it "The revelation from Jesus Christ." He is "KING OF KINGS AND LORD OF LORDS" (19:16). |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Hand motion** | 🎺 Blow a trumpet, then throw both arms up in victory: "JESUS WINS!" |

# Teacher Preparation

## Background for the teacher

The **General Letters** (also called the "Catholic" Epistles, where *catholic* simply means "universal") were written to wider audiences than Paul's letters. They come from Jesus' inner circle: two of His brothers (James and Jude), and two of the Twelve (Peter and John). Hebrews stands at the front because it is the longest, and it's a sermon-like letter to Jewish Christians who were tempted to give up following Jesus and go back to the old system of temple and sacrifices. Its message is "Don't go back. Jesus is better."

**Revelation** belongs to a type of writing called *apocalyptic*. The Greek word *apokalypsis* means "unveiling" or "revealing." It is full of symbols (lampstands, beasts, numbers, colors). Its first readers were persecuted churches under the Roman Empire, so it was meant to **encourage**, not to frighten. The big message is clear even when the details are hard: Jesus has already won through His death and resurrection, evil will be completely defeated, and God will live with His people in a renewed creation. Christians who love the Bible hold different views on the timing and details of the end times. In kids' ministry, focus on what all Christians agree on: **Jesus is coming back, Jesus wins, and God makes all things new.**

## Key truths to emphasize

1. **Jesus is better and enough.** We don't need anything else to be right with God (Hebrews 10:10–14).
2. **Real faith shows itself** in obedience, kindness, and careful words (James 2:17; 3:1–12).
3. **Suffering is not the end.** We have a living hope (1 Peter 1:3–7).
4. **God is love,** and His love makes us His children (1 John 3:1; 4:8–19).
5. **God keeps His people** and keeps His promises (2 Peter 3:9; Jude 24).
6. **Jesus wins and makes everything new** (Revelation 21:1–5).
7. **The whole Bible is one story** that leads to Jesus (Luke 24:27).

## Timeline notes

- **~AD 45–49:** James (possibly the earliest NT book)
- **~AD 62–68:** 1 & 2 Peter; Hebrews (before the temple was destroyed in AD 70)
- **~AD 65–80:** Jude
- **~AD 85–95:** 1, 2, 3 John
- **~AD 95:** Revelation, written on Patmos (a small island off the coast of modern Turkey)

**Map tip:** The seven churches of Revelation 2–3 are all in the Roman province of Asia (western Turkey), arranged roughly in a loop, like a mail route. Ephesus is the first one, the same city where Paul spent three years (Acts 19–20).

## Handling sensitive content by age

| Topic | Little Lambs (4–6) | Explorers (7–10) | Trailblazers & Ambassadors (11–17) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Revelation's beasts, dragon, plagues** | Skip the scary pictures. Focus on Jesus on His throne, the rainbow, the new home, and "no more tears." | "Revelation uses picture-language, like a dream full of symbols. Some pictures show how bad evil is, but the dragon *loses* and Jesus *wins*." | Teach the apocalyptic genre and its symbols (7 = completeness; the Lamb = Jesus). Mention that Christians hold different views on the details, and say so respectfully. |
| **Death and heaven** | "People who love Jesus go to be with Him. One day God will make a new world with no more ouchies or crying." | Let kids share about people they miss. Point them to Revelation 21:4. | Talk about grief and hope. The final hope is not just "floating in heaven" but resurrection and a new creation (1 Corinthians 15; Revelation 21). |
| **Judgment / hell** | Not a focus. "God will make everything right." | "God is fair. He will stop all evil. Anyone who trusts Jesus is safe." | Discuss honestly: God's justice is good news for victims of evil, and His patience gives everyone time to turn to Him (2 Peter 3:9). |
| **Persecution (1 Peter, Hebrews 11:35–38)** | "Some people were mean to Christians, but God was with them." | Tell plainly; highlight courage. | Discuss Christians persecuted today and how to pray for them. |

## Common kid questions (with simple answers)

- **"When is Jesus coming back?"** We don't know! Jesus said no one knows the day or hour (Matthew 24:36). So we live ready, loving God and others every day.
- **"Will heaven be boring?"** No! Revelation shows worship, celebration, a city full of light, a river, the tree of life, and God's people serving Him and reigning with Him (Revelation 22:3–5). Everything good we enjoy here comes from God. The new creation will be even better.
- **"Will my pet be in heaven?"** The Bible doesn't tell us directly. We do know God loves His creation. His new creation will be full of good things, and we can trust Him to make it perfect.
- **"Is Revelation scary?"** Some parts use scary pictures to show how bad evil is. But the ending is the happiest ending ever: Jesus wins, and there are no more tears.
- **"Does James say we're saved by being good?"** No. James says real faith *shows* by what we do, the way a living tree shows it's alive by growing fruit. We're saved by grace through faith (Ephesians 2:8). Good works are the *evidence* of that faith.
- **"Who wrote Hebrews?"** Nobody knows for sure, and that's okay! The church has always recognized it as God's Word because it teaches the truth about Jesus.
- **"Are we done with the Bible now?"** We've learned the names of all 66 books, but there's a lifetime of treasure to discover in them. Keep reading!

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## Month at a Glance

| Week | Passage | Lesson Title | Key Point | Video | Game | Activity |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Hebrews 1:1–4; 4:14–16; 11; 12:1–2; 13:8 | Jesus Is Better & the Faith Hall of Fame | Jesus is better than everything, so keep running your race of faith. | 📺 "Overview: Hebrews" (BibleProject); Sharefaith Kids "faith"; Bible Journey "heroes of faith" | 🎮 Faith Hall of Fame Relay | Hall of Fame Trophy Craft |
| **2** | James 1:19–22; 2:14–26; 3:3–12; 1 Peter 5:7; 2 Peter 3:8–9, 18 | Faith That Works, Hope That Holds | Real faith shows in actions and words, and God cares for us when life is hard. | 📺 "Overview: James," "Overview: 1 Peter," "Overview: 2 Peter" | 🎮 Tongue Twister Tag / Spark Pass | Ship & Rudder Craft |
| **3** | 1 John 1:9; 3:1; 4:7–19; 2 John 6; 3 John 4, 11; Jude 24–25 | God Is Love, Walk in Truth | God loves us like His own children, and He keeps us from falling. | 📺 "Overview: 1–3 John," "Overview: Jude" | 🎮 Love Chain Tag | "Children of God" Family Portrait |
| **4** | Revelation 1:9–18; 4–5; 21:1–5; 22:1–5, 20 | Jesus Wins! | Jesus is King. One day He will make everything new. | 📺 "Overview: Revelation 1–11," "Overview: Revelation 12–22" | 🎮 Seven Churches Mail Route | New Creation Window |
| **5** | All 66 books | Bible Bowl & Graduation Sunday | We learned the whole Bible, and the story leads to Jesus! | Highlight reel of the year's favorite clips | 🎮 The Bible Bowl | Graduation, certificates & celebration |

## Weekly Lessons

### Week 1: Jesus Is Better & the Faith Hall of Fame (Hebrews)

**Scripture:** Hebrews 1:1–4; 4:14–16; 11:1–40; 12:1–2; 13:8 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that Jesus is better than anyone or anything, and that God's people have always lived by faith, trusting Him even before they could see His promises come true.

**Opening hook / object lesson: "Good, Better, Best"** *Supplies:* three items that get "better," for example a candle (or flashlight), a lamp, and a photo of the sun. Or a paper airplane, a toy plane, and a picture of a real jet.

1. Show the candle: "This gives light. Good!" Show the lamp: "Better!" Show the picture of the sun: "BEST!"
2. Say: "God gave His people good things: prophets, angels, Moses, priests. But then God sent the BEST: His Son, Jesus! Hebrews says Jesus is better than all of them."

**Story script (read aloud):**

Long ago, a group of Christians had a hard choice. They were Jewish people who believed in Jesus, but life was getting tough. Some of their neighbors were mean to them. Some of them had lost their homes and belongings. A few started thinking, "Maybe we should stop following Jesus and go back to the old ways."

So someone wrote them a letter. We don't even know who wrote it! But the message was clear: **"Don't give up. Jesus is better!"**

"Long ago, God spoke through prophets," the letter said. "But now He has spoken to us through His Son. Jesus is the shining brightness of God's glory. He made the whole universe, and He holds it all together by His powerful word!"

"Jesus is better than the angels, because angels worship Him. Jesus is better than Moses, because Moses was a servant in God's house, but Jesus is the Son. Jesus is better than the priests, because they had to offer sacrifices again and again, but Jesus offered Himself once, and that was enough, forever!"

Then the letter said, "Do you need courage? Remember the heroes of faith!" And it told about them, one after another, like walking through a Hall of Fame.

"By faith, Noah built an ark before there was even a cloud of rain. By faith, Abraham left home without knowing where he was going. By faith, Sarah had a baby when she was very old, because she believed God keeps His promises. By faith, Moses chose to suffer with God's people instead of living like a prince in Egypt. By faith, the walls of Jericho fell down. By faith, Rahab helped God's people." There were so many more: Gideon, Samson, David, Samuel...

"What is faith?" the writer asked. "Faith is being sure of what we hope for and certain of what we don't see yet."

And then the best part: "All these heroes are like a huge crowd cheering us on! So let's throw off everything that slows us down, and run our race with perseverance, fixing our eyes on Jesus!"

The letter ended with a promise we can hold on to every single day: "Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever." He never changes. He's always better. And He'll always be there.

**Age-group teaching tips**

- **Little Lambs:** Make a "Hall of Fame" walk. Post pictures of Noah (ark), Abraham (stars), Moses (staff), and David (sling) on the wall. Walk past each one and say, "He trusted God!" At the end, put up a mirror: "And YOU can trust God too!"
- **Explorers:** Hand out hero cards from Hebrews 11. Each child reads their hero's line and acts it out, and the class guesses who it is.
- **Trailblazers:** Make a "better than" chart: Jesus vs. angels (ch. 1), Moses (ch. 3), the priests (ch. 7), and animal sacrifices (ch. 9–10). Why would this matter so much to Jewish Christians?
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss Hebrews 11:13 and 11:39–40: many heroes died "not having received" what was promised. What does it mean to trust God when you don't see results? Ask each Ambassador to share a "faith moment" from their own life with a younger group.

**Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who is the best? (Jesus!) 2) What did Noah build? (An ark.) 3) Does Jesus ever change? (No, He's always the same!)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why were the people who got this letter thinking about giving up? 2) Name two heroes of faith and what they did. 3) What is faith?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why is Jesus a better priest than the priests in the temple? 2) What things "slow you down" in your race of faith (Hebrews 12:1)? 3) Which hero in Hebrews 11 would you want to talk to, and what would you ask?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Hebrews says Jesus' sacrifice was "once for all." Why does that matter for how we feel about our sins? 2) How does "a great cloud of witnesses" encourage you? 3) What's the difference between faith and wishful thinking?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "faith" / "heroes of faith" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=faith | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Hebrews" / "heroes of faith" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Hebrews | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors (Explorers with pauses) | "Overview: Hebrews" (also the theme video "Sacrifice and Atonement") | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Hebrews |

*Teacher: Preview every video before class.* Follow-up questions: 1) What makes Jesus better than anyone else? 2) Which hero of faith do you remember from the video?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Faith Hall of Fame Relay* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Hall of Fame Trophy Craft* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Learn Hebrews 13:8 with motions (point back for "yesterday," down for "today," far forward for "forever"). Spell H-E-B-R-E-W-S. **Whole-Bible Review:** Law and History (see the review plan). 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Jesus, You are better than anything! You are the same yesterday, today and forever. Help me trust You and never give up. Amen."

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## Week 2: Faith That Works, Hope That Holds (James, 1 & 2 Peter)

**Scripture:** James 1:19–22; 2:14–26; 3:3–12; 1 Peter 1:3; 3:15; 5:7–8; 2 Peter 1:16–18; 3:8–9, 18 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that real faith shows in our actions and our words, and that God cares for us and keeps His promises when life is hard.

**Opening hook / object lesson: "The Tiny Rudder"** *Supplies:* a toy boat in a tub of water (or a picture of a big ship), a small piece of cardboard as a "rudder," a match/lighter **(teacher-only; you can use a picture of a spark instead)**, and a toothpaste tube with a paper plate.

1. Squeeze some toothpaste onto the plate. "Can you put it back in the tube?" (Kids try. It's nearly impossible!)
2. Say: "Words are like toothpaste. Once they're out, you can't put them back! James says our tongue is small, like the little rudder that steers a huge ship, or a tiny spark that can set a whole

forest on fire."

**Story script:**

> Jesus had brothers who grew up with Him in Nazareth. One of them was named James. At first, James didn't believe his big brother was the Messiah. But after Jesus rose from the dead, He appeared to James. Everything changed! James became a leader of the church in Jerusalem, and he wrote a letter.
>
> James's letter is very practical. He wrote, "Don't just listen to God's Word. DO what it says! If you only listen, you're like someone who looks in a mirror, walks away, and forgets what he looks like."
>
> "Imagine someone who has no food and no warm clothes," James said. "If you say, 'Have a nice day! Stay warm and eat well!' but you don't give them anything, what good is that? Faith that doesn't do anything is dead." Real faith is alive, and living things grow! It shows in how we act.
>
> Then James talked about our words. "Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to get angry. The tongue is small, but it's powerful. A tiny rudder steers a huge ship. A tiny spark can burn a whole forest. With the same mouth we praise God and then say mean things to people. That shouldn't happen!"
>
> Another of Jesus' friends wrote letters too: Peter, the fisherman. Remember how Peter was once so scared that he said he didn't know Jesus? Now Peter was an old man and a brave leader. Christians all over were being treated badly. Some were laughed at. Some lost their jobs. Some were even hurt.
>
> Peter wrote to them, "Praise God! Because Jesus rose from the dead, we have a *living hope*, and nothing can ruin it! When you're worried, throw all your worries on God, because He cares for you. And always be ready to tell people why you have hope."
>
> In his second letter, Peter wrote near the end of his life. Some people were saying, "Jesus isn't really coming back!" Peter said, "I was there on the mountain when I saw Jesus shine with God's glory, and I heard God's voice! God keeps His promises. If it seems like a long time, remember: to the Lord, a day is like a thousand years. He is being patient, because He wants everyone to come to Him." And Peter's very last words in the Bible are these: "Grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ!"

**Age-group teaching tips**

- **Little Lambs:** Play "Kind Words, Unkind Words." Teacher says a phrase; kids give a thumbs up for kind words or cover their mouth for unkind ones. Practice: "Thank you!" "I'm sorry!" "You can play with me!"
- **Explorers:** Act out James 2:15–16 as a skit. One person is cold and hungry. First the "faith without works" person just says "Have a nice day!" Then a second person brings a blanket and food. Ask: which one shows real faith?
- **Trailblazers:** Read James 2:14–26 next to Ephesians 2:8–10. Do they disagree? (No. Paul says we're saved by faith, not works. James says real faith produces works. Ephesians 2:10 says

we're saved *for* good works.)
- **Ambassadors:** Practice 1 Peter 3:15. Each Ambassador writes a 30-second answer to "Why do you believe in Jesus?" and shares it "with gentleness and respect."

**Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who can we give our worries to? (God!) 2) Are kind words good? (Yes!) 3) How can you help someone this week?
- *Explorers:* 1) What does "faith without deeds is dead" mean? 2) How is the tongue like a rudder or a spark? 3) Why did Peter say God seems "slow" to come back?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) How do James and Paul fit together on faith and works? 2) What are you worried about that you can "cast" on God this week? 3) What's one way to be "quick to listen and slow to speak" at home?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) How does the way Christians talk online show (or hide) their faith? 2) Why might suffering actually make faith stronger (1 Peter 1:6–7)? 3) How would you answer someone who says, "If God is real, why hasn't Jesus come back yet?"

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "kind words" / "James" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=kind+words | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Peter" / "James" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Peter | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: James," "Overview: 1 Peter," "Overview: 2 Peter" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+James |

*Teacher: Preview every video before class.* Follow-up questions: 1) What's one way you can "do" what God's Word says this week? 2) What does God want us to do with our worries?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Spark Pass* and *Tongue Twister Tag* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Ship & Rudder Craft* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Hebrews 13:8. Add "James, First and Second Peter." Spell J-A-M-E-S and P-E-T-E-R. **Whole-Bible Review:** Poetry and the Prophets (see the review plan). 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Dear God, help my faith show in what I do. Help my words be kind. Thank You that I can give You my worries, because You care for me. Amen."

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## Week 3: God Is Love, Walk in Truth (1, 2, 3 John & Jude)

**Scripture:** 1 John 1:1–9; 3:1; 4:7–19; 5:13; 2 John 4–6; 3 John 1–11; Jude 3, 24–25 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that God loves us so much that He makes us His children, that we show His love by loving others and living in truth, and that God keeps us from falling.

**Opening hook / object lesson: "Lavished!"** *Supplies:* a small cup, a large pitcher of water, a tray or tub underneath, and paper hearts.

1. Hold the small cup over the tray and pour water from the pitcher. Keep pouring until the cup overflows all over the tray.

2. Say: "John says God's love is *lavished* on us. That means He pours and pours, way more than we could ever hold! It overflows. When God's love fills us up, it spills out onto other people."

**Story script:**

> Remember John? He was one of Jesus' twelve disciples, a fisherman with his brother James. Jesus called them the "Sons of Thunder," maybe because they had big tempers! John was there when Jesus walked on water, when Jesus died on the cross, and when Jesus rose again. John even outran Peter to the empty tomb!
>
> Now John was an old man, probably the last of the twelve still alive. He took care of churches, and he loved them like a grandpa. He called them "my dear children."
>
> John wrote, "We saw Jesus with our own eyes. We heard Him. We even touched Him! And we're telling you about Him so you can be part of God's family with us."
>
> "Look how much the Father loves us!" John wrote. "He calls us His children, and that's what we are! God is love. This is what love is: not that we loved God first, but that He loved us and sent His Son to take away our sins. So, dear friends, since God loved us so much, we should love one another. We love because He first loved us."
>
> John also wanted his friends to be sure. "If we confess our sins, God is faithful and fair, and He will forgive us. I write these things so you can KNOW you have eternal life."
>
> John wrote two tiny letters too. One went to a church family he called "the chosen lady and her children." He told them, "Keep walking in truth and love." The other went to a good friend named Gaius, who always welcomed traveling missionaries into his home. John said, "Nothing makes me happier than hearing that my children are walking in the truth! Keep doing what is good." But there was a bossy man named Diotrephes who wanted to be first and wouldn't welcome anyone. John said, "Don't copy what is evil. Copy what is good."
>
> Jesus' brother Jude also wrote a short letter. Some people were teaching lies about Jesus, and Jude said, "Stand strong for the true faith!" Then he ended with one of the most beautiful blessings in the Bible: "To Him who is able to keep you from stumbling and to bring you into His glorious presence without fault and with great joy, to the only God our Savior, be glory forever! Amen."

**Age-group teaching tips**

- **Little Lambs:** Hug-and-say: "God loves ME! I'm God's child!" Pass a heart around the circle; each child says, "God loves you, [name]!"
- **Explorers:** Have kids count how many times the word "love" appears in 1 John 4:7–12 (NIV: love/loved/loves appears many times; let them discover it). Then write "We love because He first loved us" on a heart.
- **Trailblazers:** List the "tests" John gives to know you belong to God: believing in Jesus (5:1), obeying Him (2:3), and loving others (3:14). Talk about assurance: can we *know* we have eternal life (5:13)?

- **Ambassadors:** Discuss truth and love together (2 John 3–6). Why do Christians sometimes have truth without love, or love without truth? How did Jesus show both?

**Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who loves you more than anyone? (God!) 2) What does God call us? (His children.) 3) Who can you love this week?
- *Explorers:* 1) What does "lavished" mean? 2) What happens when we confess our sins? 3) Why was John happy with Gaius but not with Diotrephes?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) John says "God is love." Does that mean "love is God"? Why does the order matter? 2) How can you "walk in the truth" at school? 3) What does it mean that God can keep you from stumbling?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) What does it mean to "contend for the faith" without being mean? 2) Why does it matter that John *touched* Jesus (1 John 1:1)? 3) How can you be sure you have eternal life without being proud about it?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "God is love" / "love one another" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=God+is+love | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "John" / "apostle John" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=apostle+John | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: 1–3 John," "Overview: Jude" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+John |

*Teacher: Preview every video before class.* Follow-up questions: 1) How does God show that He loves us? 2) How can we show God's love to others?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Love Chain Tag* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *"Children of God" Family Portrait* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Hebrews 13:8. Add "First, Second, Third John, Jude." Spell J-O-H-N (silent H!) and J-U-D-E. **Whole-Bible Review:** Gospels, Acts and Paul's Letters (see the review plan). 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Father God, thank You for pouring Your love on me and calling me Your child. Help me love others the way You love me. Thank You for keeping me from falling. Amen."

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## Week 4: Jesus Wins! (Revelation)

**Scripture:** Revelation 1:9–18; 4:1–11; 5:1–14; 21:1–5; 22:1–5, 13, 20 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that Jesus is alive and in charge, that He has defeated evil, and that one day He will make everything new and live with His people forever.

**Opening hook / object lesson: "Peek at the Last Page"** *Supplies:* a picture book with a happy ending, and a puzzle box (with the box cover showing the finished picture) plus a few loose pieces.

1. Show a few puzzle pieces: "Can you tell what the picture is?" (Hard!) Then show the box cover: "NOW you know how it turns out."

2. Say: "Sometimes life feels like a bunch of mixed-up puzzle pieces. But God gave us the last book of the Bible, Revelation, to show us the box cover: how the story ends. Spoiler alert: JESUS WINS!"

**Story script:**

> John was an old man now, and he was in trouble for telling people about Jesus. The Romans sent him away to a small, rocky island called Patmos. He was far from his friends and his churches. But on the Lord's Day, something amazing happened.
>
> John heard a loud voice behind him, like a trumpet. He turned around and saw Jesus! But Jesus looked different from how John remembered Him. His face was shining like the sun at its brightest. His eyes were like flames of fire. His voice sounded like rushing waters. John fell down at His feet like he was dead.
>
> But Jesus put His right hand on John and said, "Don't be afraid. I am the First and the Last. I am the Living One. I was dead, and look, I am alive forever and ever!"
>
> Jesus told John, "Write down what you see and send it to seven churches." Then John saw a door open in heaven. He saw God's throne, with a rainbow around it shining like an emerald. Angels and creatures were worshiping day and night: "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord God Almighty!"
>
> In God's hand was a scroll sealed with seven seals. An angel asked, "Who is worthy to open the scroll?" No one in heaven or on earth could open it, and John began to cry. But an elder said, "Don't cry! Look! The Lion of the tribe of Judah has won! He can open the scroll!"
>
> John looked for a lion, but he saw a Lamb that looked as if it had been slain. It was Jesus, who died for us and rose again! Then millions and millions of angels sang, "Worthy is the Lamb who was slain!" and every creature everywhere joined in.
>
> John saw many more visions. Some of them showed how terrible evil is, and how God will stop it once and for all. And at the very end, John saw the best thing of all: a new heaven and a new earth! A beautiful city came down from God, shining like a jewel. A loud voice said, "Now God's home is with His people! He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death, or crying, or pain!"
>
> Jesus, sitting on the throne, said, "Look! I am making everything new!" There was a river, clear as crystal, flowing from God's throne, and on each side grew the tree of life. God's people will see His face, and they will live with Him forever.
>
> Almost the very last words of the Bible are a promise and a prayer. Jesus says, "Yes, I am coming soon." And John answers, "Amen. Come, Lord Jesus!"

**Age-group teaching tips**

- **Little Lambs:** Focus on three pictures: Jesus shining bright, the rainbow throne, and the new home with no tears. Pretend to wipe tears from each other's cheeks: "No more crying!" Then

cheer: "JESUS WINS!"

- **Explorers:** Point out connections. The tree of life was in Genesis 2 and appears again in Revelation 22. The Bible's first and last pages match! Ask them: "What else from Genesis comes back?" (A garden, a river, God living with people, and no more curse, Revelation 22:3.)
- **Trailblazers:** Explore the symbols: the Lion and the Lamb (power through sacrifice), seven (completeness), and the throne (God is in charge). Read the letter to one church (for example, Laodicea, 3:14–22) and ask what Jesus would say to our church.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss how Revelation encouraged persecuted Christians: the Roman Empire looked unstoppable, but the Lamb is on the throne. Read Revelation 7:9–10 (every nation, tribe, people and language) and talk about God's worldwide family. Mention respectfully that Christians hold different views on the end-times details, but all agree on the ending.

**Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who did John see? (Jesus!) 2) Will there be crying in God's new home? (No!) 3) Who wins? (JESUS!)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why was John on the island of Patmos? 2) Why did John cry, and who made him stop? 3) What will be in God's new heaven and new earth?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why is Jesus called both a Lion and a Lamb? 2) How does the end of the Bible connect to the beginning? 3) How does knowing the ending help you when life is hard?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Revelation was written to suffering churches. What does it tell persecuted Christians today? 2) Why is "new creation" a bigger hope than just "going to heaven when you die"? 3) If Jesus said, "I am coming soon," how should that change the way you live this week?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "heaven" / "Revelation" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=heaven | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Revelation" / "John on Patmos" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Revelation | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: Revelation 1–11," "Overview: Revelation 12–22" (also "Heaven and Earth" or "The Day of the Lord" theme videos) | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Revelation |

*Teacher: Preview every video before class. Revelation videos may show some intense images; choose clips carefully for younger groups.* Follow-up questions: 1) What's your favorite thing about God's new creation? 2) How did John's vision show that Jesus is in charge?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Seven Churches Mail Route* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *New Creation Window* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Hebrews 13:8 for everyone. Add "Revelation" and sing the full 66-book song! Spell R-E-V-E-L-A-T-I-O-N (no S!). **Whole-Bible Review:** General Letters, Revelation, and the full run of all 66 (see the review plan). 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Jesus, You are the First and the Last, and You win! Thank You that one day there will be no more tears. Come, Lord Jesus! Amen."

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### Week 5: Bible Bowl & Graduation Sunday

See **End-of-Phase Review & Celebration** below for the full Bible Bowl format, the 40 questions and answers, and the Graduation Sunday program with certificate wording.

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## Book Memory Song & Motions

### 🎵 New verse for the last nine books (tune: *"Row, Row, Row Your Boat"*)

> 🎵 *Hebrews, James, and Peter, Peter, John and John and John and Jude! Revelation, Revelation, Jesus wins! Jesus wins! Sixty-six — we're through!*
>
> *(Verse 2, sung slower and softer, then building up): Faith and hope and love, Jesus wins the day! Genesis to Revelation, Sixty-six books — HOORAY!*

*Tip:* "Hebrews, James, and Peter, Peter" fits "Row, row, row your boat." Hold up 1, then 2 fingers on the two Peters, and 1, 2, 3 fingers on the three Johns. "Revelation, Revelation, Jesus wins! Jesus wins!" fits the fast "merrily, merrily..." line. Sing it as a round once kids know it!

### 🎵 The Grand Finale: Cumulative Book Chant (all 66 books)

Use a clap-clap-slap rhythm. (Classes may also sing each section to the tune they learned in that phase. See the Memory System.)

> **OLD TESTAMENT!** *(arms wide like an open book)*
>
> Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy — **"FIVE books of LAW!"** *(5 fingers)*
>
> Joshua, Judges, Ruth, First and Second Samuel, First and Second Kings, First and Second Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther — **"TWELVE books of HISTORY!"** *(10 + 2 fingers)*
>
> Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs — **"FIVE books of POETRY!"** *(air harp)*
>
> Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel — **"FIVE MAJOR PROPHETS!"** *(big muscles)*
>
> Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi — **"TWELVE MINOR PROPHETS!"** *(pinky muscle)*
>
> **"THIRTY-NINE in the OLD!"** *(stomp, stomp)*
>
> **NEW TESTAMENT!** *(arms wide again)*
>
> Matthew, Mark, Luke, John — **"FOUR GOSPELS!"** *(make a cross)*
>
> Acts — **"ONE book of HISTORY: THE CHURCH IS BORN!"** *(flame and go)*

> Romans, First and Second Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, First and Second Thessalonians, First and Second Timothy, Titus, Philemon — **"THIRTEEN LETTERS FROM PAUL!"** *(write with a quill)*
>
> Hebrews, James, First and Second Peter, First, Second, Third John, Jude — **"EIGHT GENERAL LETTERS!"** *(8 fingers)*
>
> Revelation — **"ONE book of PROPHECY: JESUS WINS!"** *(trumpet, then arms up)*
>
> **"TWENTY-SEVEN in the NEW!"** *(stomp, stomp)*
>
> **"SIXTY-SIX BOOKS: THE WHOLE BIBLE — GOD'S WORD IS TRUE!"** *(everyone jumps and cheers!)*

## Hand motions for the last nine books

| # | Book | Motion |
|---|---|---|
| 58 | Hebrews | A thumbs up that moves higher and higher: "Good, better, BEST!" |
| 59 | James | Zip your lips, then roll up your sleeves |
| 60 | 1 Peter | 1 finger, a fist ("rock"), then toss your worries up |
| 61 | 2 Peter | 2 fingers, then crouch and grow tall |
| 62 | 1 John | 1 finger, then hug yourself |
| 63 | 2 John | 2 fingers, then march in place |
| 64 | 3 John | 3 fingers, then a big welcome wave |
| 65 | Jude | Trip, then catch yourself |
| 66 | Revelation | Blow a trumpet, then arms up: "JESUS WINS!" |

## Section Shouts (the last two)

**Teacher:** "How many General Letters?" **Kids:** "EIGHT! Hebrews, James, Peter, Peter, John, John, John, Jude!" **Teacher:** "How many books of Prophecy at the end?" **Kids:** "ONE: REVELATION! JESUS WINS!" **Teacher:** "How many books in the whole Bible?" **Kids:** "SIXTY-SIX!"

## Cumulative recall drill (5 minutes)

1. **Section Sprint:** Call any of the 10 library sections. Kids chant that section only.
2. **Bookends:** Teacher says a section, and kids name its *first* and *last* book (for example, Paul's Letters: Romans and Philemon).
3. **What's next? / What's before?:** The teacher names any of the 66 books, and kids shout the next one (older kids also give the one before).
4. **Silent Bible:** Teacher does only the motions, and kids name the books.
5. **66 in 66:** Can the class (or an individual Ambassador) chant all 66 books in 66 seconds or less? Track the class record on the board all month.

### Tips for each age group

- **Little Lambs:** Know the 10 Section Shouts and do all the shouts with the big kids. Know the first book (Genesis) and the last book (Revelation). Say at least one book from each Testament.
- **Explorers:** Chant all 66 with the song, using section color cards as helps.
- **Trailblazers:** Say all 66 alone, and name the section each book is in.
- **Ambassadors:** Say all 66 fast, backward from Revelation to Genesis, and lead the chant on Graduation Sunday.

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## Spelling & Reading

### Spelling lists by age group

**Little Lambs (letter recognition & sound it out)**

- First letters: **H** for Hebrews (and Hope!), **J** for James, John, Jude (and Jesus!), **P** for Peter, **R** for Revelation.
- Sound it out: J-U-D-E ("J... oo... d"), J-A-M-E-S.
- Bookend words: trace **GENESIS** (first) and **REVELATION** (last).

**Explorers (book names)**

- Hebrews, James, Peter, John, Jude, Revelation. Review: Genesis, Exodus, Psalms, Isaiah, Matthew, Acts, Romans.

**Trailblazers (book names + 5 vocab words)**

- All nine new books, written correctly as 1 Peter, 2 Peter, 1 John, 2 John, 3 John
- Vocab: **faith** (trusting God about what we can't see yet), **hope** (being sure God will keep His promises), **priest** (someone who brings people to God; Jesus is our High Priest), **revelation** (something shown or uncovered), **eternal** (lasting forever)

**Ambassadors (book names + harder vocab with definitions)**

- All 66 books. Watch for the tricky ones: Deuteronomy, Ecclesiastes, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Philippians, Colossians, Thessalonians, Revelation.
- **perseverance**: keeping on and not giving up when it's hard (Hebrews 12:1)
- **atonement**: the work of Jesus that makes us "at one" with God by paying for sin
- **apocalyptic**: a type of writing that uses symbols and visions to reveal God's plan (from *apokalypsis*, "unveiling")
- **covenant**: a binding promise-relationship God makes with His people (the "new covenant," Hebrews 8)
- **Alpha and Omega**: the first and last letters of the Greek alphabet, meaning "the Beginning and the End" (Revelation 22:13)

## The syllable-clap method

| Word | Claps |
|---|---|
| He-brews | 2 |
| James | 1 |
| Pe-ter | 2 |
| John | 1 |
| Jude | 1 |
| Rev-e-la-tion | 4 |
| per-se-ver-ance | 4 |
| a-poc-a-lyp-tic | 5 |

## "Spell It Out" relay (Graduation Edition)

*Supplies:* Letter cards for **REVELATION**, **HEBREWS**, **GENESIS**, and **BIBLE**; two baskets; a tape line.

1. Teams race to build the word, one letter per runner.
2. When they finish, the whole team spells it aloud and gives the book's "In one word."
3. **Final round:** Both teams build **G-E-N-E-S-I-S** and **R-E-V-E-L-A-T-I-O-N** at the same time, then lay them at opposite ends of the room as "bookends." Everyone lines up between them and chants all 66!
4. Little Lambs find the first letter only. Ambassadors spell **PERSEVERANCE** or **APOCALYPTIC**.

## Mini spelling bee word list

| Word | Use it in a sentence |
|---|---|
| Jude | "Jude is a short letter with only 25 verses." |
| James | "James says faith shows in what we do." |
| John | "John wrote that God is love." |
| Peter | "Peter told us to cast our worries on God." |
| hope | "We have a living hope because Jesus rose." |
| faith | "By faith, Noah built an ark." |
| Hebrews | "Hebrews says Jesus is better than everything." |
| eternal | "God gives eternal life to all who trust Jesus." |
| forever | "Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever." |
| Revelation | "Revelation shows that Jesus wins." |
| Genesis | "Genesis is the first book and Revelation is the last." |
| perseverance | "Run with perseverance the race marked out for us." |

| Word | Use it in a sentence |
|---|---|
| Deuteronomy | "Deuteronomy is the fifth book of Law." |
| Ecclesiastes | "Ecclesiastes says to remember your Creator." |
| Thessalonians | "Thessalonians teaches that Jesus is coming back." |

### Read-aloud practice passage

> **Revelation 21:3–5 (NIV):** "And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying, 'Look! God's dwelling place is now among the people, and he will dwell with them. They will be his people, and God himself will be with them and be their God. He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the old order of things has passed away.' He who was seated on the throne said, 'I am making everything new!'"
>
> *Little Lambs:* echo "No more crying!" and "I am making everything new!"

## Word Trivia

### ⭐ Easy (Little Lambs / Explorers)

1. What is the last book of the Bible?
2. How many books are in the whole Bible?
3. Fill in the blank: "Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and _____."
4. True or False: In God's new creation, there will be no more crying.
5. Who wins at the end of the Bible?
6. What gentle, woolly animal starting with L is Jesus called in Revelation?
7. What other animal starting with L, one that roars, is Jesus called?
8. Fill in the blank: "God is _____." (1 John 4:8)
9. What did Noah build by faith?
10. True or False: Peter said we should keep our worries all to ourselves.

### ⭐⭐ Medium (Explorers / Trailblazers)

11. Which book has the "Faith Hall of Fame"?
12. Who wrote the book of James? (Hint: he grew up with Jesus!)
13. Which book? "Faith by itself, if it is not accompanied by action, is dead."
14. James says the tongue is like what two small things?
15. Fill in the blank: "Cast all your _____ on him because he cares for you." (1 Peter 5:7)
16. On what island was John when he wrote Revelation?
17. Which three books in a row have the same name?
18. Who said it? "I am the First and the Last. I am the Living One; I was dead, and now look, I am alive for ever and ever!"

19. Which book? "See what great love the Father has lavished on us, that we should be called children of God!"
20. How many churches got letters in Revelation 2–3?
21. Which book has only 25 verses and was written by a brother of James?
22. True or False: Hebrews tells us exactly who wrote it.
23. What tree is in both Genesis and Revelation?
24. What three-word prayer comes near the very end of the Bible?

## ⭐⭐⭐ Hard (Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

25. Fill in the blank: "Now faith is confidence in what we _____ _____ and assurance about what we do not see." (Hebrews 11:1)
26. Which mysterious king-priest does Hebrews compare Jesus to?
27. Which book? "Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry."
28. Who said it? "Always be prepared to give an answer to everyone who asks you to give the reason for the hope that you have."
29. In 2 Peter, what event did Peter say he saw as an eyewitness?
30. Fill in the blank: "With the Lord a day is like a _____ _____." (2 Peter 3:8)
31. Which book has the fewest verses in the Bible?
32. In 3 John, who was the bossy man who "loves to be first"?
33. In 3 John, who was the friend that John praised for welcoming travelers?
34. Name four of the seven churches in Revelation 2–3.
35. What did the elder tell John when he was weeping in Revelation 5?
36. What does "Alpha and Omega" mean?
37. Which book? "To him who is able to keep you from stumbling..."
38. True or False: James and Paul disagree about faith and works.
39. Which book? "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock."
40. Name the 8 General Letters in order.

## Answer key

1. Revelation. 2. 66. 3. forever. 4. True (Revelation 21:4). 5. Jesus! 6. Lamb. 7. Lion (of the tribe of Judah, Revelation 5:5). 8. love. 9. An ark (Hebrews 11:7). 10. False: cast them on God (1 Peter 5:7).
2. Hebrews (ch. 11). 12. James, the brother of Jesus. 13. James (2:17). 14. A rudder on a ship and a spark that starts a forest fire (James 3:4–6). 15. anxiety. 16. Patmos (Revelation 1:9). 17. 1, 2 and 3 John. 18. Jesus (Revelation 1:17–18). 19. 1 John (3:1). 20. Seven. 21. Jude. 22. False: the author is unknown. 23. The tree of life (Genesis 2:9; Revelation 22:2). 24. "Come, Lord Jesus" (Revelation 22:20).
3. hope for. 26. Melchizedek (Hebrews 5–7; Genesis 14:18). 27. James (1:19). 28. Peter (1 Peter 3:15). 29. The Transfiguration: Jesus shining with glory on the mountain, and God's voice saying "This is my Son" (2 Peter 1:16–18). 30. thousand years. 31. 2 John (13 verses). 32. Diotrephes (3 John 9). 33. Gaius (3 John 1, 5–8). 34. Any four: Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, Laodicea. 35. "Do not weep! See, the Lion of the tribe of Judah... has triumphed" (Revelation 5:5). 36. The First and the Last, the Beginning and the End (the first and last letters of the Greek alphabet). 37. Jude (v. 24). 38. False: they agree. We are saved by faith, and real faith

shows in works (Ephesians 2:8–10; James 2:18). 39. Revelation (3:20). 40. Hebrews, James, 1 Peter, 2 Peter, 1 John, 2 John, 3 John, Jude.

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## Games

### 🎮 1. Faith Hall of Fame Relay

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** Hero picture cards (Noah = ark, Abraham = stars, Sarah = baby, Moses = staff, Rahab = red cord, Gideon = trumpet & jar, David = sling); tape; a finish-line "trophy" (a cup covered in foil)
- **Setup:** Spread the hero cards face-down at the far end of the room.
- **How to play:** Runners race to flip one card, shout "By faith, [hero]...!" and finish the sentence (for example, "By faith, Noah built an ark!"), then run back and tag the next teammate. When all the cards are flipped, the team runs together to the trophy and says Hebrews 13:8.
- **How to win:** First team to finish all their heroes and say the verse wins.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* pair up with a buddy, and say just the hero's name and "trusted God!" *Older:* must also name the Old Testament book where that hero's story is found (Noah: Genesis, Moses: Exodus, Rahab: Joshua, Gideon: Judges, David: 1 Samuel).
- **Learning goal:** Hebrews 11 and connecting it to the Old Testament books.

### 🎮 2. Spark Pass

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers
- **Supplies:** A red or orange ball (the "spark"), music
- **How to play:** Kids sit in a circle and pass the "spark" while music plays. When the music stops, the person holding it must say something **kind** about the person to their right (taming the tongue!) **or** name the next book in the 66-book order (the class keeps the count). If they can't, the spark "spreads." They stand up, and the round continues until everyone has had a turn.
- **How to win:** The whole class wins if you get through all 66 books in one game.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* say "God loves you!" to the next person. *Older:* say a verse from James or 1 Peter.
- **Learning goal:** James 3: words are powerful. Book order.

### 🎮 3. Tongue Twister Tag

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors
- **Supplies:** Open space, a list of tongue twisters
- **How to play:** It's freeze tag. To get unfrozen, a teammate must come and say a Bible tongue twister to you three times fast: "Peter's pen penned powerful promises," "Jude judged jumpy jesters," "Hebrews has heroes of hope," "Seven churches' cheerful chairs." Funny mistakes are part of it. Remind kids: "If we can't even control our tongue in a tongue twister, we need God's help with our words!"
- **How to win:** Taggers try to freeze everyone in 2 minutes. Then switch.

- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* freeze dance with "kind words" to unfreeze. *Older:* to unfreeze, you must name the 8 General Letters.
- **Learning goal:** James 3 (taming the tongue) and remembering the new book names.

### 🎮 4. Love Chain Tag

- **Best for:** All ages (great for Little Lambs with walking instead of running)
- **Supplies:** Open space
- **How to play:** One "It" starts. When It tags someone, they link arms and say together, "We love because He first loved us!" The chain grows as it tags more players. Only the two ends of the chain can tag.
- **How to win:** Keep going until everyone is part of the chain, God's whole family!
- **Adaptations:** *Older:* each new link must name a book of the Bible in order, starting from Genesis.
- **Learning goal:** 1 John 4:19. Love spreads, and we're all one family.

### 🎮 5. Seven Churches Mail Route

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors
- **Supplies:** Seven boxes or hoops labeled Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia and Laodicea, set in a loop around the room (the real route was roughly a circle); seven envelopes with a short message from Revelation 2–3 in each
- **How to play:** Teams of "messengers" from Patmos must deliver the envelopes **in the correct route order**. At each stop they read the one-line message aloud (for example, Ephesus: "Return to your first love," 2:4–5; Smyrna: "Be faithful, even to the point of death," 2:10; Laodicea: "I stand at the door and knock," 3:20).
- **How to win:** Fastest correct route.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* only 3 stops, with picture clues. *Older:* after delivering, say what Jesus might say to our church today.
- **Learning goal:** Revelation 2–3 and Jesus' care for real churches.

### 🎮 6. Bookend Dash (66-book review game)

- **Best for:** All ages, in mixed teams
- **Supplies:** Two complete sets of 66 book cards, color-coded by the 10 library sections; two long tables or floor space; a "GENESIS" sign and a "REVELATION" sign for each team
- **How to play:** Teams race to place all 66 books in order between their Genesis and Revelation signs. Little Lambs place the 10 section header cards. Explorers place the New Testament books. Trailblazers and Ambassadors place the Old Testament books. When done, the team chants all 66 while pointing to each card.
- **How to win:** First correct shelf wins. The teacher checks with the answer list.
- **Learning goal:** The whole Bible library, in order and by section.

### 🎮 7. The Bible Bowl

The year-end championship. Full format and 40 questions are in **End-of-Phase Review & Celebration** below.

## Coloring Pages

🖍️ **Coloring page 1: The Faith Hall of Fame (Week 1)** *Scene:* A grand hallway with framed portraits: Noah with the ark, Abraham looking at the stars, Moses with his staff at the Red Sea, Rahab with a red cord in a window, and David with his sling. At the end of the hall is a big empty frame labeled "YOU!" for the child to draw themselves. *Caption:* "Fixing our eyes on Jesus." (Hebrews 12:2) *Coloring conversation:* Which hero is your favorite? How can you trust God like they did?

🖍️ **Coloring page 2: The Tiny Rudder (Week 2)** *Scene:* A big sailing ship on the ocean, with a close-up circle showing its small rudder. A smiling kid at the bottom has a speech bubble that says "Kind words!" *Caption:* "Quick to listen, slow to speak." (James 1:19) *Coloring conversation:* What kind words can you say this week? Who needs to hear them?

🖍️ **Coloring page 3: Children of God (Week 3)** *Scene:* A huge heart with many kids of every kind inside it, holding hands. A big hand from heaven is pouring love (drawn as water or light) over them. *Caption:* "See what great love the Father has lavished on us!" (1 John 3:1) *Coloring conversation:* How does it feel to be God's child? Who can you show His love to?

🖍️ **Coloring page 4: The Lion and the Lamb (Week 4)** *Scene:* A shining throne with a rainbow around it. In front of it stand a lion and a lamb side by side, and angels sing above them. *Caption:* "Worthy is the Lamb!" (Revelation 5:12) *Coloring conversation:* Why is Jesus called both a Lion and a Lamb? What will you sing to Jesus?

🖍️ **Coloring page 5: Everything New! (Week 4)** *Scene:* A beautiful garden-city with a crystal river flowing from a throne, the tree of life on both banks covered in fruit, and happy people of every nation with no tears. Sunlight is everywhere. *Caption:* "I am making everything new!" (Revelation 21:5) *Coloring conversation:* What do you think the new creation will be like? What are you most excited about?

🖍️ **Coloring page 6: Book Name Page: The Whole Library** *Design:* A big bookshelf with 66 book spines in 10 labeled sections (Law, History, Poetry/Wisdom, Major Prophets, Minor Prophets, Gospels, Acts, Paul's Letters, General Letters, Revelation). Each spine has a book name for kids to color by section. A banner across the top says "I KNOW ALL 66!" *Caption:* "All Scripture is God-breathed." (2 Timothy 3:16)

> **Printable book-name coloring sheet and word search: see `../printables/phase-12-printables.html`**

## Activities & Crafts

### ✂️ 1. Hall of Fame Trophy Craft (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** Paper cups, aluminum foil, pipe cleaners (handles), gold stickers, paper labels, markers
- **Steps:** 1) Turn a cup upside down and stack a second cup on top. Cover them with foil to make a trophy. 2) Add pipe-cleaner handles. 3) Write the label "By faith..." and the name of a Hebrews 11 hero, or "By faith, [your name] will..."
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* pre-wrapped trophies, with a sticker label "I trust God!" *Explorers:* write a hero's name. *Older:* write one area of life where you need faith right now.
- **What it teaches:** Hebrews 11 and living by faith.

### ✂️ 2. Ship & Rudder Craft (Week 2)

- **Supplies:** Foam or paper plates (hulls), craft sticks (masts), paper sails, small cardboard rudders, brads (paper fasteners), markers
- **Steps:** 1) Build a little ship. 2) Attach a rudder with a brad so it can turn. 3) Write "My words steer my life" on the sail and "James 3:4" on the rudder.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* glue paper boats onto a blue page and add the sticker "Kind words!" *Older:* write 3 kind words they'll use this week on the sail.
- **What it teaches:** James 3: our words are small but powerful.

### ✂️ 3. "Children of God" Family Portrait (Week 3)

- **Supplies:** Paper frames, crayons, mirror stickers or photos, heart stickers
- **Steps:** Kids draw themselves inside a frame along with their church "family." Write across the top: "We are God's children!" (1 John 3:1).
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* draw self + heart. *Older:* add 1 John 4:19 and draw someone they'll show love to this week.
- **What it teaches:** God's love makes us His family.

### ✂️ 4. New Creation Window (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Black construction paper frames, colored tissue paper or cellophane, clear contact paper, scissors
- **Steps:** 1) Cut a window shape from black paper. 2) Fill it with tissue-paper pieces on contact paper, including a river (blue), the tree of life (green), and a throne with a rainbow. 3) Hang it in a sunny window so the light shines through, the way God's glory lights the city (Revelation 21:23).
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* free-form colors. *Older:* plan the design with the details from Revelation 21–22.
- **What it teaches:** God will make everything new.

### ✂️ 5. My Whole-Bible Bookshelf (all month)

- **Supplies:** A printed bookshelf with 66 empty spines (or 10 section shelves), colored markers in 10 colors, a section color key
- **Steps:** Each week, color in the books reviewed that week (see the Whole-Bible Review Plan) and write a tiny symbol on each spine. By Graduation Sunday the shelf is full!
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* color the 10 sections with stickers. *Older:* write each book's "in one word" on its spine.
- **What it teaches:** The whole Bible library, in order.

### ✂️ 6. Bible Passport Finale Page

- **Supplies:** The class's Bible Passports, gold star stickers, a photo of each child (optional)
- **Steps:** Kids add a final page: "My favorite Bible story this year was ___ because ___." Then they add their photo and the final gold "Forever Crown" stamp.
- **What it teaches:** Reflection and celebration of the whole year.

### ✂️ 7. Graduation Crown (for Graduation Sunday)

- **Supplies:** Gold cardstock crowns (template), jewels/stickers, markers
- **Steps:** Decorate a crown and write "66 of 66!" on the front. Wear it during the Graduation processional.
- **What it teaches:** "The crown of righteousness" (2 Timothy 4:8) and celebrating finishing the race.

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## Word Puzzles

### Word scramble

1. WSERBEH
2. MSEAJ
3. TPERE
4. NHJO
5. EDJU
6. NOELTAVIRE
7. IATFH
8. EPHO
9. VLEO
10. BALM
11. NILO
12. SOPATM
13. TRONEH
14. RREFEOV
15. YTXSI-XSI

**Answer key:** 1. HEBREWS 2. JAMES 3. PETER 4. JOHN 5. JUDE 6. REVELATION 7. FAITH 8. HOPE 9. LOVE 10. LAMB 11. LION 12. PATMOS 13. THRONE 14. FOREVER 15. SIXTY-SIX

## Fill-in-the-blank story

*Word bank: better, faith, Noah, James, words, worries, love, children, Patmos, Lamb, tears, new, sixty-six*

> Hebrews says Jesus is _____ than everyone, and it tells about heroes of _____, like _____ who built an ark. Jesus' brother _____ said real faith shows in what we do, and that our _____ are powerful. Peter said to give all our _____ to God. John wrote that God is _____ and that we are His _____. John saw visions on the island of _____. He saw Jesus as a _____ on the throne. In God's new home there will be no more _____, and Jesus will make everything _____. Now we know all _____ books of the Bible!

**Answers:** better, faith, Noah, James, words, worries, love, children, Patmos, Lamb, tears, new, sixty-six

## Match the book to its picture / summary

| Book | Picture / Summary |
|---|---|
| 1. Hebrews | A. 🎺 Jesus wins and makes everything new |
| 2. James | B. 🤗 God is love; we are His children |
| 3. 1 Peter | C. 🚶 Walk in truth and love (only 13 verses!) |
| 4. 2 Peter | D. 🏆 Jesus is better; the Faith Hall of Fame |
| 5. 1 John | E. 🛡️ God keeps you from stumbling |
| 6. 2 John | F. 🛠️ Faith that works; tame your tongue |
| 7. 3 John | G. 🌱 Grow in grace; God is patient |
| 8. Jude | H. 👋 Welcome travelers; copy what is good |
| 9. Revelation | I. 🪨 Living hope; cast your worries on God |

**Answers:** 1-D, 2-F, 3-I, 4-G, 5-B, 6-C, 7-H, 8-E, 9-A

**Bonus: Bookends Match.** Match each "first" to its "last." | First book of the section | Last book of the section | |---|---| | Genesis (Law) | a. Esther | | Joshua (History) | b. Philemon | | Job (Poetry) | c. Deuteronomy | | Isaiah (Major Prophets) | d. Malachi | | Hosea (Minor Prophets) | e. Song of Songs | | Matthew (Gospels) | f. Daniel | | Romans (Paul's Letters) | g. John | | Hebrews (General Letters) | h. Jude |

**Answers:** Genesis-c, Joshua-a, Job-e, Isaiah-f, Hosea-d, Matthew-g, Romans-b, Hebrews-h

## Questions for Every Age

**Little Lambs (ages 4–6)**

1. What was your favorite Bible story this year?
2. Who is the Bible all about? (Jesus!)
3. How does God show He loves you?
4. What will God's new home be like?
5. Who can you tell a Bible story to this week?

**Explorers (ages 7–10)**

1. Which hero of faith are you most like?
2. How can your faith show in what you do this week?
3. When do you need to be "slow to speak"?
4. What's one thing you learned about the Bible this year that surprised you?
5. Now that you know the 66 books, which one do you want to read next?

**Trailblazers (ages 11–13)**

1. What does it mean that Jesus is "the same yesterday, today and forever" when everything else changes?
2. How do your words show what's in your heart (James 3)?
3. When life is hard, what helps you keep hope?
4. How does knowing the end of the story (Revelation) change how you live now?
5. How does the Bible fit together as one story? Can you tell it in one minute?

**Ambassadors (ages 14–17)**

1. What is one thing you're tempted to "go back to" instead of following Jesus (Hebrews' warning)?
2. Is your faith visible in your actions, or only in your words?
3. How would you explain the hope of the new creation to a friend who is grieving?
4. What is your plan to keep reading the Bible after this year?
5. Who will you invest in, the way Paul invested in Timothy, as you help lead younger kids?

### 🧠 Big Questions for Ambassadors (apologetics & worldview)

1. **"How can 66 books by around 40 authors over about 1,500 years tell one story?"** *Suggested answer:* The Bible's authors include kings, shepherds, fishermen, a doctor, a tax collector and prophets. They wrote in three languages (Hebrew, Aramaic and Greek) on three continents. Yet the story holds together: creation, the fall, God's promise, Israel, the coming King, Jesus' death and resurrection, the church, and the new creation. Genesis 3:15 promises a Rescuer who will crush the serpent. Revelation 12 and 20 show the ancient serpent defeated. The tree of life is lost in Genesis 3 and restored in Revelation 22. Jesus Himself said the Scriptures are about Him (Luke 24:27; John 5:39). Christians believe this unity comes from one divine Author working through many human authors (2 Peter 1:20–21).

2. **"Doesn't James contradict Paul about faith and works?"** *Suggested answer:* They're answering different problems. Paul (Romans 3–4; Ephesians 2:8–9) is answering people who thought they could earn salvation by keeping rules, and he says no, it's by faith alone. James (2:14–26) is answering people who claimed to have faith but lived as though they didn't, and he says that kind of "faith" is dead. Both use Abraham as an example: his faith was credited as righteousness (Genesis 15:6), and his faith was shown in his obedience (Genesis 22). Paul himself says we are saved "for good works" (Ephesians 2:10). The Reformers summed it up this way: "We are saved by faith alone, but the faith that saves is never alone."
3. **"Isn't heaven just wishful thinking, something people made up to feel better about death?"** *Suggested answer:* Christian hope isn't based on wishing. It's based on a historical event, the resurrection of Jesus (1 Peter 1:3; 1 Corinthians 15:14–20). If Jesus rose, then death has already been defeated once, and His promise to raise us is believable. The Bible's picture is also more solid than clouds and harps. It is a renewed, physical creation with justice, beauty, work, worship and relationships (Revelation 21–22). Also, wishful thinking would probably invent a heaven without judgment, but the Bible honestly includes God's justice. A hope that comes with a real event, real eyewitnesses and real moral seriousness isn't what wishful thinking looks like.

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## End-of-Phase Review & Celebration

This month's celebration has four parts:

1. **The Whole-Bible Review Plan.** It runs all month and reviews all 66 books.
2. **Phase 12 Review & Oral Check-off.** This is the final check-off, covering the whole Bible.
3. **The Bible Bowl.** The year-end competition, with 40 questions and answers.
4. **Graduation Sunday.** The program, the awards and the certificate wording.

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### Part 1: The Whole-Bible Review Plan (All 66 Books)

#### Goal

By the end of the month every child can (at their own level) **say, spell, and place** the books of the Bible, and tell **God's Big Story** from Genesis to Revelation.

#### God's Big Story in 9 Scenes (teach with motions)

| # | Scene | Books | Kid sentence | Motion |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Creation** | Genesis 1–2 | God made everything, and it was very good. | Make a big circle (the world) |
| 2 | **Fall** | Genesis 3 | People disobeyed God, and sin broke everything. | Drop your hands, then make a sad face |
| 3 | **Promise** | Genesis 12–50 | God chose Abraham's family to bless the whole world. | Point up to the stars |

| # | Scene | Books | Kid sentence | Motion |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | **Rescue** | Exodus–Deuteronomy | God freed His people from Egypt and gave them His good rules. | Part the "sea" with both arms |
| 5 | **Kingdom** | Joshua–2 Chronicles | God gave them a land and kings, and promised a forever King from David's family. | Put on a crown |
| 6 | **Exile & Return** | Kings, Ezra–Esther, the Prophets | God's people turned away and were sent far from home. God brought them back, and the prophets promised a Messiah. | Walk away, then walk back |
| 7 | **Jesus** | Matthew–John | The King came! Jesus lived, died for our sins, and rose again. | Make a cross, then arms up |
| 8 | **Church** | Acts–Jude | The Holy Spirit came, and the good news spread everywhere. | Flame fingers, then throw your hands out |
| 9 | **New Creation** | Revelation | Jesus will come back and make everything new forever. | Big circle again, then jump! |

**Practice:** Kids say all nine scenes with motions in under a minute. Ambassadors tell the whole Big Story to younger kids in their own words.

### Four-week review schedule (uses the 10-minute Welcome & Book Chant slot)

| Week | Sections reviewed | Books | Running review | 10-minute plan |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Law + History | Genesis → Esther (17) | 17 of 66 | 2 min full chant · 3 min "Section Spotlight" (read the kid summaries below for these 17) · 3 min Bookend Dash (OT history shelf only) · 2 min Big Story scenes 1–6 |
| **2** | Poetry + Major Prophets + Minor Prophets | Job → Malachi (22) | 39 of 66 | 2 min full chant · 3 min Spotlight · 3 min "What's Next?" drill · 2 min "400 silent years" reminder (between Malachi and Matthew) |
| **3** | Gospels + Acts + Paul's Letters | Matthew → Philemon (18) | 57 of 66 | 2 min full chant · 3 min Spotlight · 3 min Mail Carrier Dash (from Phase 11) · 2 min Big Story scenes 7–8 |
| **4** | General Letters + Revelation, then all 66 | Hebrews → Revelation (9) + all | 66 of 66 | 2 min full chant · 3 min Spotlight · 3 min "66 in 66" challenge · 2 min Big Story, all 9 scenes |
| **5** | Everything | All 66 | 🎉 | Bible Bowl + Graduation |

### The Whole-Bible Review Table (all 66 books)

Use this table for Section Spotlights, flashcards, and the Bookend Dash. Each book has a kid summary and a picture symbol. The symbol is a flashcard cue, not a hand motion.

**Hand motions for the review:** use the same motions kids learned all year, so the whole program stays consistent.

- **Law, History & Poetry (Phases 1–6):** Genesis: sunrise hands (palms together like a book, open, sweep arms up) · Exodus: walk two fingers across your palm and out the "door" · Leviticus: fold hands in prayer, then raise them high · Numbers: count 1-2-3-4 on your fingers, then zig-zag your hand · Deuteronomy: two fingers up, tap your head, hand on heart · Joshua: march with a fist-trumpet · Judges: pound a gavel on your palm, then draw a circle · Ruth: scoop grain, then hug yourself · 1 & 2 Samuel: 1 or 2 fingers, then cup your ear · 1 & 2 Kings: 1 or 2 fingers, then a crown on your head · 1 & 2 Chronicles: 1 or 2 fingers, then unroll a scroll · Ezra: stack your fists like bricks · Nehemiah: hammer + shield · Esther: crown, then "speak up" hands · Job: open your hands up, then fold them over your heart · Psalms: strum a harp · Proverbs: tap your head · Ecclesiastes: puff into your hand, then point up · Song of Songs: heart hands.
- **Isaiah through John (Phases 7–9):** use the motions from Phase 7, Phase 8 and Phase 9.
- **Acts through Revelation (Phases 10–12):** see Phase 10, Phase 11 and the motion table in this file's Book Memory Song section.

📜 **LAW (5)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 1 | Genesis | God makes everything good, people sin, and God promises a Rescuer through Abraham's family. | 🌍 | | 2 | Exodus | God frees His people from slavery in Egypt and gives them the Ten Commandments. | 🌊 | | 3 | Leviticus | God shows His people how to be holy and come near Him through sacrifices. | 🐑 | | 4 | Numbers | Israel grumbles and wanders 40 years in the wilderness, but God stays faithful. | 🔢 | | 5 | Deuteronomy | Moses reminds the new generation: "Love the Lord your God with all your heart." | 📜 |

🏰 **HISTORY (12)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 6 | Joshua | God helps Joshua lead Israel into the Promised Land, and Jericho's walls fall. | 🎺 | | 7 | Judges | Israel keeps forgetting God, and He sends judges like Deborah, Gideon and Samson to rescue them. | 🔄 | | 8 | Ruth | Loyal Ruth trusts God, marries Boaz, and becomes the great-grandmother of King David. | 🌾 | | 9 | 1 Samuel | Samuel anoints Israel's first kings, Saul and then David, who defeats Goliath. | 🪨 | | 10 | 2 Samuel | David rules as king, and God promises a forever King from his family. | 👑 | | 11 | 1 Kings | Solomon builds the temple, the kingdom splits in two, and Elijah stands up for God. | 🔥 | | 12 | 2 Kings | Elisha does miracles, but many kings turn from God, and the people are taken into exile. | ⛓️ | | 13 | 1 Chronicles | David's story is told again, with family trees, focused on worship and God's promise. | 🌳 | | 14 | 2 Chronicles | Judah's kings from Solomon to the exile, and God's invitation to return to Him. | 🏛️ | | 15 | Ezra | God's people come home, rebuild the temple, and Ezra teaches God's law. | 🔨 | | 16 | Nehemiah | Nehemiah leads the people to rebuild Jerusalem's walls in 52 days. | 🧱 | | 17 | Esther | Brave Queen Esther saves her people, and God works behind the scenes. | 👸 |

🎵 **POETRY / WISDOM (5)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 18 | Job | Job loses almost everything but learns to trust God even when he doesn't understand. | 🙏 | | 19 | Psalms | 150 songs and prayers for every feeling: happy, sad, scared and thankful. | 🎵 | | 20 | Proverbs | Wise sayings that teach us how to live God's way. | 💡 | | 21 | Ecclesiastes | Life without God is empty, like chasing the wind, so remember your Creator. | 💨 | | 22 | Song of Songs | A love poem celebrating the love between a husband and wife, a gift from God. | 💕 |

📣 **MAJOR PROPHETS (5)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 23 | Isaiah | God is holy, and He promises a Servant-King who will suffer for our sins. | 🕊️ | | 24 | Jeremiah | The "weeping

prophet" warns Judah and promises a new covenant written on hearts. | 🏺 | | 25 | Lamentations | Sad poems about fallen Jerusalem, and yet God's mercies are new every morning. | 🌅 | | 26 | Ezekiel | Visions of God's glory, dry bones coming to life, and God giving new hearts. | 🦴 | | 27 | Daniel | Daniel and his friends stay faithful in Babylon, and God rescues them from fire and lions. | 🦁 |

📯 **MINOR PROPHETS (12)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 28 | Hosea | God's love stays faithful even when His people are unfaithful. | 💍 | | 29 | Joel | A locust plague warns of the Day of the Lord, and God promises to pour out His Spirit. | 🦗 | | 30 | Amos | A shepherd prophet says: "Let justice roll on like a river!" | ⚖️ | | 31 | Obadiah | The shortest Old Testament book: God judges proud Edom. | ⛰️ | | 32 | Jonah | Jonah runs from God, is swallowed by a big fish, and learns that God loves even his enemies. | 🐋 | | 33 | Micah | Act justly, love mercy, and walk humbly with God. A ruler will come from Bethlehem. | ⭐ | | 34 | Nahum | God judges cruel Nineveh, and He is a refuge for those who trust Him. | 🏰 | | 35 | Habakkuk | A prophet asks God hard questions and learns to trust and rejoice anyway. | ❓ | | 36 | Zephaniah | The Day of the Lord is coming, but God rejoices over His people with singing. | 🎶 | | 37 | Haggai | Put God first, and rebuild His temple! | 🏗️ | | 38 | Zechariah | Visions of hope and a King coming, riding on a donkey. | 🫏 | | 39 | Malachi | Return to God. A messenger will come to prepare the way. (Then come 400 "silent years.") | ☀️ |

✝️ **GOSPELS (4)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 40 | Matthew | Jesus is the promised King, the Son of David, who fulfills the Old Testament. | 💰 | | 41 | Mark | The fast-moving story of Jesus, the Servant who came to give His life. | 🏃 | | 42 | Luke | A doctor carefully tells about Jesus, the Savior who seeks and saves the lost. | 🩺 | | 43 | John | Jesus is God's Son. Believe in Him and have life! | ❤️ |

🔥 **HISTORY: ACTS (1)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 44 | Acts | The Holy Spirit comes, and the church spreads the good news from Jerusalem to Rome. | 🔥 |

✉️ **PAUL'S LETTERS (13)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 45 | Romans | Everyone has sinned, but God's gift is eternal life through Jesus. | 🛣️ | | 46 | 1 Corinthians | We are one body, and love is the greatest. | ❤️ | | 47 | 2 Corinthians | God's power is made perfect in our weakness. | 💪 | | 48 | Galatians | Freedom in Christ and the fruit of the Spirit. | 🍎 | | 49 | Ephesians | Saved by grace, so put on the armor of God. | ⛑️ | | 50 | Philippians | Rejoice in the Lord always, even in chains! | 😀 | | 51 | Colossians | Jesus is over everything and holds it all together. | 👑 | | 52 | 1 Thessalonians | Jesus is coming back, so keep hoping! | ☁️ | | 53 | 2 Thessalonians | Keep working and doing good while you wait. | 🔨 | | 54 | 1 Timothy | Be an example, even if you're young. | 👍 | | 55 | 2 Timothy | All Scripture is God-breathed, so finish the race. | 📖 | | 56 | Titus | God was kind to us, so be ready to do good. | 🧱 | | 57 | Philemon | Forgive, and welcome each other back like family. | 🤝 |

📬 **GENERAL LETTERS (8)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 58 | Hebrews | Jesus is better than everything, so keep the faith. | 🏆 | | 59 | James | Real faith shows in what you do and say. | 🛠️ | | 60 | 1 Peter | Living hope when life is hard: cast your worries on God. | 🪨 | | 61 | 2 Peter | Grow in grace. God is patient and keeps His promises. | 🌱 | | 62 | 1 John | God is love, and we can know we have eternal life. | 🤗 | | 63 | 2 John | Walk in truth and love. | 🚶 | | 64 | 3 John | Welcome and help those who serve God, and copy what is good. | 👋 | | 65 | Jude | Stand strong for the faith. God can keep you from falling. | 🛡️ |

🎺 **PROPHECY: REVELATION (1)** | # | Book | Kid summary | Symbol | |---|---|---|---| | 66 | Revelation | Jesus wins and makes everything new! | 🎺 |

**Optional extended review Sunday: "Bible Journey Stations"**

If you have an extra Sunday (or a long Saturday event), set up **10 stations**, one for each library section, with Ambassadors as station leaders. Groups rotate every 6 minutes.

| Station | Section | Activity |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Law | "Creation Countdown": put the 7 days of creation cards in order, then chant the 5 books. |
| 2 | History | "Jericho Walls": stack 12 cups labeled with the History books in order, then knock them down with a "trumpet" shout. |
| 3 | Poetry | "Psalm Karaoke": sing Psalm 23 or a psalm song, then name the 5 Poetry books. |
| 4 | Major Prophets | "Lion's Den Freeze": everyone freezes like lions while a child names the 5 books. |
| 5 | Minor Prophets | "Big Fish Toss": toss a beanbag fish into buckets labeled with the 12 books in order. |
| 6 | Gospels | "Four Friends": do the four Gospel motions from Phase 9, then match each Gospel to a picture of its story. |
| 7 | Acts | "Wind Relay" (from Phase 10). |
| 8 | Paul's Letters | "Mail Carrier Dash" (from Phase 11). |
| 9 | General Letters | "Count on Your Fingers": say the 8 letters while counting on your fingers. |
| 10 | Revelation | "No More Tears": each child writes or draws one thing they're excited about in God's new creation and pins it on a "New Jerusalem" poster. |

Give each child a **Journey Card** with 10 boxes and stamp it at each station.

---

## Part 2: Phase 12 Review & Oral Check-off (Final Whole-Bible Check-off)

**Review game plan (Week 4 or a dedicated review Sunday)**

| Time | Activity |
|---|---|
| 10 min | Welcome, the full 66-book chant, and the Big Story in 9 scenes |
| 15 min | 🎮 Bookend Dash (all 66) |
| 10 min | Favorite video replay, then a "Which book was it from?" quiz |
| 20 min | Oral check-off stations (Ambassadors help with the younger groups) |
| 15 min | Finish your Whole-Bible Bookshelf and Bible Passport finale page |

| Time | Activity |
|---|---|
| 5 min | Prayer of thanks for the year |

### Oral check-off checklist

#### Little Lambs

- ☐ Says "Jesus Christ is the same… forever."
- ☐ Says the first book (Genesis) and the last book (Revelation)
- ☐ Says all 10 Section Shouts with the class (Law, History, Poetry, Major Prophets, Minor Prophets, Gospels, Acts, Paul's Letters, General Letters, Revelation)
- ☐ Names at least 3 books from each Testament
- ☐ Tells one favorite Bible story from the year

#### Explorers

- ☐ Says Hebrews 13:8
- ☐ Says and spells all 9 books from this phase
- ☐ Says all 66 books in order (section cards allowed as helps)
- ☐ Puts the 10 sections in order and tells how many books are in each

#### Trailblazers

- ☐ Says Hebrews 13:8 and 2 Timothy 3:16
- ☐ Says all 66 books in order without help
- ☐ Gives a one-sentence summary of any book the teacher picks (5 random picks)
- ☐ Tells the Big Story in 9 scenes

#### Ambassadors

- ☐ Says all 66 books in order, then backward from Revelation to Genesis
- ☐ Teaches one book of their choice to a younger child (summary, motion, and where Jesus shows up)
- ☐ Explains how the Bible is one story that points to Jesus (2–3 minutes)
- ☐ Answers one Big Question from this phase in their own words

### 🛂 Bible Passport stamp

Stamp: a **golden crown above an open book**, with the words "REVELATION — 66 of 66 — JESUS WINS!" On Graduation Sunday, add the final full-page stamp: **"WHOLE BIBLE EXPLORER: GENESIS TO REVELATION."**

### 🏅 Badge description: The Forever Crown

A gold badge shaped like a crown, with a sky-blue gem in the center. Inside the gem is a tiny tree of life. Around the edge: "FAITH · HOPE · FOREVER · HEBREWS 13:8 · 66 of 66."

### 🏅 Year-end medal: Whole Bible Champion

A gold medal on a ribbon striped in the colors of all 12 phases. The front reads "66 BOOKS · ONE STORY · JESUS." The back reads "Purpose Church Sunday School · Whole Bible Explorer · [Year]." Give it to every child who completes their age group's final check-off. (Give every child a participation ribbon too, so no one leaves empty-handed.)

---

## Part 3: The Bible Bowl 🏆

A fun, high-energy, year-end competition. It is mixed-age by design: older kids help younger ones shine.

### Format overview

- **Length:** About 45 minutes (fits Week 5 before Graduation, or a Saturday event)
- **Teams:** 4–6 teams of 4–6 players. **Every team should have at least one player from each age group** (Little Lamb, Explorer, Trailblazer, Ambassador) when possible. Teams pick names from the Bible library sections (Team Law, Team Prophets, Team Gospels, Team Letters…) and wear matching colors.
- **Rounds:** 4 rounds of 10 questions, plus tiebreakers
- **Volunteers needed:** Quizmaster (reads questions), Scorekeeper (large whiteboard), Timekeeper (10-second timer), Judges (1–2, to settle answers), Runner (carries answer slates)

### Supplies

- A buzzer or bell for each team (or have teams raise a colored flag)
- Small whiteboards and markers (one per team) for written-answer rounds
- A scoreboard (whiteboard or poster)
- A timer, the question cards (below), prizes, the trophy (a decorated "golden Bible" or a cup)
- A "Lamb Card" for each team (see the rules)

### Rules

1. **Rounds 1 & 3 (Slate Rounds):** Every team writes its answer on a whiteboard within 15 seconds. All teams with the correct answer score points.
2. **Rounds 2 & 4 (Buzzer Rounds):** The first team to buzz answers within 5 seconds. If they're wrong, the next team may steal for half points (round down).
3. 🐑 **Lamb Questions:** Questions marked 🐑 must be answered by the team's youngest player (teammates may not whisper!). A correct Lamb answer earns **double points.**
4. **Help Card:** Once per game, each team may use its "Ask a Friend" card to let the whole team huddle for 20 seconds on a buzzer question.
5. **Kindness rule:** Teams lose 1 point for unkind words or arguing with the judges, and gain 1 bonus point when a judge sees great teamwork or encouragement (James 1:19!).
6. **Judges' decision is final.** Accept reasonable spellings and equivalent wording.

### Scoring

| Round | Name | Points per correct answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | The Library (books & order) | 1 (Lamb = 2) |
| 2 | Old Testament Adventures | 2 (Lamb = 4) |
| 3 | New Testament Adventures | 2 (Lamb = 4) |
| 4 | Which Book? Lightning Round | 3 (Lamb = 6) |

## 🎤 The 40 Bible Bowl Questions

**Round 1: The Library (slate round, 1 point each)**

1. 🐑 How many books are in the whole Bible?
2. 🐑 What is the first book of the Bible?
3. 🐑 What is the last book of the Bible?
4. How many books are in the Old Testament, and how many in the New Testament?
5. Name the four Gospels.
6. What book comes right after Malachi?
7. What book comes between John and Romans?
8. Name the five books of the Law, in order.
9. Which book has the most chapters?
10. In which section of the Bible library do you find the book of Jonah?

**Round 2: Old Testament Adventures (buzzer round, 2 points each)** 11. 🐑 What did God create on the very first day? 12. 🐑 Who built a giant boat called an ark? 13. 🐑 What did God put in the sky as a promise after the flood? 14. Who was sold by his brothers, then became a leader in Egypt? 15. Who led God's people out of Egypt and through the Red Sea? 16. Which city's walls fell down after Israel marched around it for seven days? 17. Who said, "Where you go I will go... Your people will be my people and your God my God"? 18. What did young David use to defeat the giant Goliath? 19. Which queen risked her life to save her people, saying, "If I perish, I perish"? 20. Which man was thrown into a den of lions because he kept praying to God?

**Round 3: New Testament Adventures (slate round, 2 points each)** 21. 🐑 In what town was Jesus born? 22. Who baptized Jesus in the Jordan River? 23. 🐑 How many apostles (special disciples) did Jesus choose? 24. When Jesus fed a huge crowd with 5 loaves and 2 fish, about how many men were there? 25. Finish the verse: "For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever..." 26. On what day after He died did Jesus rise from the dead? 27. Who came on the disciples on the day of Pentecost, with wind and tongues of fire? 28. Who met Jesus in a blinding light on the road to Damascus? 29. What were Paul and Silas doing at midnight in the Philippian jail? 30. 🐑 In God's new creation, what will God wipe from every eye?

**Round 4: "Which Book?" Lightning Round (buzzer round, 3 points each)** *Quizmaster reads a quote or description, and teams name the book.* 31. "In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." 32. "The Lord is my shepherd, I lack nothing." 33. "Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding." 34. "For to us a child is born... And he will be called Wonderful Counselor,

Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." 35. A prophet runs from God, is swallowed by a great fish, and then preaches to the city of Nineveh. 36. "But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah... out of you will come for me one who will be ruler over Israel." 37. "Love is patient, love is kind." 38. "Faith by itself, if it is not accompanied by action, is dead." 39. "Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice!" 40. "He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain."

## ✅ Bible Bowl Answer Key

| # | Answer | Reference |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 66 | — |
| 2 | Genesis | — |
| 3 | Revelation | — |
| 4 | 39 Old Testament, 27 New Testament | — |
| 5 | Matthew, Mark, Luke, John | — |
| 6 | Matthew | — |
| 7 | Acts | — |
| 8 | Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy | — |
| 9 | Psalms (150 chapters/psalms) | — |
| 10 | Minor Prophets | — |
| 11 | Light | Genesis 1:3–5 |
| 12 | Noah | Genesis 6–9 |
| 13 | A rainbow | Genesis 9:12–16 |
| 14 | Joseph | Genesis 37–50 |
| 15 | Moses | Exodus 14 |
| 16 | Jericho | Joshua 6 |
| 17 | Ruth (speaking to Naomi) | Ruth 1:16 |
| 18 | A sling and a stone | 1 Samuel 17:49–50 |
| 19 | Esther | Esther 4:16 |
| 20 | Daniel | Daniel 6 |
| 21 | Bethlehem | Luke 2:4–7; Matthew 2:1 |
| 22 | John the Baptist | Matthew 3:13–17 |
| 23 | Twelve | Mark 3:14–19 |
| 24 | About 5,000 men (besides women and children) | Matthew 14:21 |
| 25 | "...believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life." | John 3:16 |
| 26 | The third day (the first day of the week, Sunday) | Luke 24:1–7; 1 Corinthians 15:4 |
| 27 | The Holy Spirit | Acts 2:1–4 |

| # | Answer | Reference |
|---|---|---|
| 28 | Saul (later called Paul) | Acts 9:1–6 |
| 29 | Praying and singing hymns to God | Acts 16:25 |
| 30 | Every tear | Revelation 21:4 |
| 31 | Genesis | Genesis 1:1 |
| 32 | Psalms | Psalm 23:1 |
| 33 | Proverbs | Proverbs 3:5 |
| 34 | Isaiah | Isaiah 9:6 |
| 35 | Jonah | Jonah 1–3 |
| 36 | Micah | Micah 5:2 |
| 37 | 1 Corinthians | 1 Corinthians 13:4 |
| 38 | James | James 2:17 |
| 39 | Philippians | Philippians 4:4 |
| 40 | Revelation | Revelation 21:4 |

### Tiebreakers (use in order until the tie is broken)

- **T1:** How many psalms are in the book of Psalms? *(150)*
- **T2:** Who lived longer than anyone else in the Bible, and how old was he? *(Methuselah, 969 years — Genesis 5:27)*
- **T3:** What is the shortest verse in most English Bibles? *("Jesus wept." — John 11:35)*
- **T4:** Who was the first king of Israel? *(Saul — 1 Samuel 10)*
- **T5 (Sudden-Death Chant):** One player from each tied team says the 66 books in order. The fastest without a mistake wins (a judge listens to each player).

### Bible Bowl awards

- 🏆 **Bible Bowl Champions:** the trophy and a champions certificate for each member
- 🥈 **Runner-up:** ribbons
- 🐑 **Lamb of the Bowl:** the young player with the most correct Lamb answers
- 💛 **Team Spirit Award** (James 1:19): the team that showed the most kindness and encouragement
- 🎖️ **Every player:** a participation ribbon that reads "I played in the Bible Bowl!"

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## Part 4: Graduation Sunday 🎓

A joyful celebration of the whole year. Invite families, grandparents and the whole church! Choose **Option A** (a full kids' program during Sunday school time) and/or **Option B** (a short recognition in the main worship service).

### Before the day (2–3 weeks out)

- [ ] Send the family invitation (it's on the Take-Home Family Page)
- [ ] Print certificates (wording below) and sign them (lead teacher + pastor)
- [ ] Order or make Whole Bible Champion medals, participation ribbons and the Bible Bowl trophy
- [ ] Prepare a slideshow of photos from all 12 phases
- [ ] Decorate: a "66 Books" bookshelf wall, the 12 phase badges on banners, gold and sky-blue balloons
- [ ] Ask the pastor to give a blessing and present the certificates
- [ ] Choose kid readers for the Big Story readings and rehearse them
- [ ] Arrange a reception (cake decorated as an open Bible, or 66 cupcakes, each topped with a book name). *Check for allergies.*
- [ ] Ambassadors rehearse leading the 66-book chant

### Option A: Kids' Graduation Celebration (75 minutes)

| Time | Program item | Who | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0:00 | **Processional** | All kids, wearing their Graduation Crowns | Kids enter by age group to a joyful worship song. Families stand and clap. |
| 0:04 | **Welcome & opening prayer** | Lead teacher | Script below |
| 0:07 | **Opening song: the 66-Book Grand Finale Chant** | All kids, led by Ambassadors | All 10 Section Shouts and motions. Families are invited to join the last shout! |
| 0:12 | **God's Big Story in 9 Scenes** | 9 kid readers (mixed ages), with the whole class doing the motions | Each reader says one scene's sentence from the review table. |
| 0:20 | **Phase-by-phase slideshow** | AV volunteer | 12 phases, 1–2 slides each, with the phase badge |
| 0:28 | **Little Lambs performance** | Little Lambs | "Jesus Christ is the same… forever!" plus a favorite song from the year |
| 0:32 | **Explorers performance** | Explorers | Spell 5 hard book names on the "big stage" (Deuteronomy, Ecclesiastes, Habakkuk, Philippians, Revelation) |
| 0:36 | **Trailblazers performance** | Trailblazers | Say all 66 books, then each says one book summary |
| 0:42 | **Ambassador testimonies** | 2–3 Ambassadors | 1–2 minutes each: "What God taught me this year" |
| 0:50 | **Bible Bowl Champions recognized** | Bible Bowl Quizmaster | Trophy presentation and the champions certificates |
| 0:54 | **Certificate & medal presentation** | Pastor + lead teacher | Call each child by name, give the certificate and medal, and stamp the final Bible Passport page |

| Time | Program item | Who | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1:05 | **Commissioning of Ambassadors** as Junior Leaders | Pastor | Script below. Ambassadors who will help lead next year stand at the front. |
| 1:09 | **Blessing over the children** | Pastor (families lay a hand on their child's shoulder) | Numbers 6:24–26 |
| 1:12 | **Closing song & recessional** | All | Kids walk out to their families |
| 1:15 | **Reception** | Hospitality team | Cake, photos at the "66 Books" wall |

### Scripts

**Welcome (lead teacher):**

> "Welcome, families and friends! Twelve months ago, these children opened the first page of the Bible: 'In the beginning…' Since then they've walked with Abraham, crossed the Red Sea with Moses, marched around Jericho, sung psalms with David, listened to the prophets, met Jesus in the Gospels, watched the church be born, read Paul's letters, and just finished the very last page, where Jesus says, 'I am making everything new!' Today we celebrate that these kids know all 66 books of God's Word. More importantly, they know the One the whole Bible is about: Jesus. Let's pray."

**Opening prayer:**

> "Father, thank You for Your Word, all 66 books of it. Thank You for every child here, and for every teacher and family who helped them learn. Today we celebrate what You have done. Jesus, You are the same yesterday and today and forever. Be honored in this celebration. Amen."

**Big Story readers (one line each, with the class doing the motions):**

> 1. "In the beginning, God made everything, and it was very good." (Creation)
> 2. "But people disobeyed God, and sin broke everything." (Fall)
> 3. "God promised Abraham that his family would bless the whole world." (Promise)
> 4. "God rescued His people from Egypt and gave them His good rules." (Rescue)
> 5. "God gave them a land and kings, and promised a forever King from David's family." (Kingdom)
> 6. "God's people turned away and were sent far from home, but God brought them back and promised a Messiah." (Exile & Return)
> 7. "Then Jesus came! He lived, died for our sins, and rose again!" (Jesus)
> 8. "The Holy Spirit came, and the good news spread all over the world, all the way to us!" (Church)

> 9. "One day Jesus will come back and make everything new, forever!" (New Creation) **All:** "Sixty-six books, ONE story — JESUS!"

**Commissioning of Ambassadors (pastor):**

> "Ambassadors, Paul told Timothy, 'Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young, but set an example' (1 Timothy 4:12). You have learned God's Word this year, and you have helped younger kids learn it too. Will you keep reading God's Word, keep following Jesus, and keep helping the younger ones learn about Him?" **Ambassadors:** "We will, with God's help!" "Church family, will you pray for these young leaders and encourage them?" **Congregation:** "We will!" *(The pastor prays for them.)*

**Blessing (pastor; families place a hand on their child's shoulder):**

> "The Lord bless you and keep you; the Lord make his face shine on you and be gracious to you; the Lord turn his face toward you and give you peace." (Numbers 6:24–26)

### Option B: Main-Service Recognition (10–15 minutes)

1. Kids process to the front during the last worship song (2 min).
2. The pastor introduces them: "These kids learned all 66 books this year!" (1 min).
3. The kids chant the 66 books with motions, led by Ambassadors (2 min).
4. One Ambassador gives a 1-minute testimony.
5. The Bible Bowl champions are recognized (1 min).
6. Certificates are presented. For large groups, call the names by age group and hand out certificates in the classroom afterward (3–5 min).
7. The pastor blesses the children (Numbers 6:24–26) and the congregation applauds (1 min).

### Awards list (optional extra recognitions)

| Award | Given to |
|---|---|
| 🥇 **Whole Bible Champion** medal | Everyone who completed their age-group final check-off |
| 📖 **All 66 Award** | Kids who can say all 66 books alone |
| 🐝 **Super Speller** | The top speller in each age group (from the year's spelling bees) |
| 🛂 **Full Passport** | Kids with all 12 phase stamps |
| ⏰ **Faithful Attender** | Kids who missed 4 Sundays or fewer |
| 🤝 **Servant Heart** | Ambassadors and helpers who served the younger groups |
| 🏆 **Bible Bowl Champions** | The winning team |
| 🎖️ **Participation ribbon** | **Every child** ("I'm part of God's big story!") |

## 📜 Certificate wording

### 1. Phase 12 Certificate (Forever Crown)

> **Purpose Church Sunday School Bible Explorer Certificate — Phase 12: Faith, Hope & Forever**
>
> This certifies that _____ has learned the books of **Hebrews, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1, 2 & 3 John, Jude, and Revelation**, and can say the books of the Bible from **Genesis to Revelation: 66 of 66!**
>
> "Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever." (Hebrews 13:8)
>
> Awarded the **Forever Crown Badge** on _____ (date).
>
> Teacher: _____

### 2. Whole Bible Graduation Certificate (main certificate for Graduation Sunday)

> **PURPOSE CHURCH SUNDAY SCHOOL Certificate of Completion WHOLE BIBLE EXPLORER**
> *Genesis to Revelation*
>
> This is to certify that _____ has faithfully completed all twelve phases of the Purpose Church Sunday School Bible curriculum, learning the names, order and message of all **66 BOOKS OF THE BIBLE** from the Law to the Prophets, from the Gospels to the Letters, all the way to Revelation, and has discovered that the whole Bible tells one story pointing to **Jesus**.
>
> Age group: ☐ Little Lambs ☐ Explorers ☐ Trailblazers ☐ Ambassadors
>
> "All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness." (2 Timothy 3:16)
>
> Presented on _____ (date), in the year _____.
>
> _____ Lead Teacher _____ Pastor

### 3. Bible Bowl Champion Certificate

> **Purpose Church Sunday School 🏆 BIBLE BOWL CHAMPION 🏆**
>
> Congratulations to _____, a member of **Team** _____, champions of the year-end Bible Bowl!
>
> "Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved... who correctly handles the word of truth." (2 Timothy 2:15)

> Date: _____ Quizmaster: _____

**4. Ambassador Junior Leader Commissioning Certificate**

> **Purpose Church Sunday School Junior Leader Commission**
>
> _____ has served as an **Ambassador** this year, learning all 66 books of the Bible and helping younger children learn God's Word. Today they are commissioned as a **Junior Leader** for the coming year.
>
> "Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith and in purity." (1 Timothy 4:12)
>
> Commissioned on _____ (date).
>
> _____ Pastor _____ Children's Ministry Leader

**5. Participation Certificate (for every child who attended any part of the year)**

> **Purpose Church Sunday School I'm Part of God's Big Story!**
>
> _____ joined us on the journey through God's Word this year. We are so glad you were here! Keep reading, keep learning, and keep following Jesus.
>
> "Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." (Psalm 119:105)
>
> Date: _____ Teacher: _____

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## Take-Home Family Page

**Dear Parents and Families,**

**We did it!** This month your child learned the last nine books of the Bible: **Hebrews, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1, 2 & 3 John, Jude, and Revelation.** Your child now knows **all 66 books of the Bible**, Genesis to Revelation! We learned that Jesus is better than everything (Hebrews), that real faith shows in what we do and say (James), that we have a living hope (1 & 2 Peter), that God is love (1–3 John), that God keeps us from falling (Jude), and that Jesus wins and makes everything new (Revelation).

🎓 **You're invited to Graduation Sunday!** Date: _____ Time: _____ Place: _____ Come celebrate with your child! There will be songs, the Bible Bowl champions, certificates and medals, a blessing for every child, and cake. Grandparents and friends are welcome!

**This month's verse:** "Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever." (Hebrews 13:8) **Little Lambs:** "Jesus Christ is the same... forever."

🎵 **This month's song** (tune: *"Row, Row, Row Your Boat"*):

> Hebrews, James, and Peter, Peter, John and John and John and Jude! Revelation, Revelation, Jesus wins! Jesus wins! Sixty-six — we're through!

*Ask your child to teach you the full 66-book chant with the motions. See if your family can say all 66 in 66 seconds!*

🍽️ **Dinner-table questions**

1. What was your favorite Bible story from this whole year, and why?
2. How can our family show "faith that works" (James 2) this week?
3. What are you most excited about in God's new creation (Revelation 21–22)?

🏠 **Family activity: "Keep the Story Going"** Now that your child knows the names of all 66 books, help them start *reading* them! Choose a family Bible reading plan for the new year. For example, read one chapter of Mark a night (16 nights), then John (21 nights), or use a children's story Bible together. Make a family "bookshelf" chart and color in each book as you read it. Celebrate every finished book!

📺 **Videos to watch at home** (search on YouTube. Parents, please preview them first.)

- **@SharefaithKids**: search "heaven" or "faith": https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=heaven
- **@BibleJourneyTV**: search "Revelation" or "Peter": https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Revelation
- **@bibleproject**: "Overview: Hebrews," "Overview: James," and "Overview: Revelation 12–22" (best for ages 11+). A great follow-up for the whole family is BibleProject's "Overview" series, which has a video for every book of the Bible: https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Revelation

*Thank you for partnering with us this year. Your child has learned the whole Bible library. Now let's help them spend a lifetime reading it, loving it, and following the Jesus it's all about!*